

Thirty-one facades. Pick ten.

Every grammar the facade kit has, photographed on the same shell within its family, from three angles. Reply with the numbers you want and each one becomes a whole cultural city — the picked facade plus three more siblings in the same tradition.

THREE-QUARTER

The honest single frame: entrance face and one flank at once, so ornament applied only to the front cannot hide.

FROM THE PAVEMENT

Where a player actually meets the building. Judges the door, the reach, and whether it still reads from underneath.

REAR THREE-QUARTER

The cheat detector: a facade that spent everything on the door elevation looks fine in the other two frames and empty here. On tower plates this frame is the crown instead — a tower wraps all four faces by construction, and what it lives on is how it ends.



The whole sheet

Numbers come from a literal order in the tool, not from registry order — so “I want 4, 9, 17 and 22” still means the same four buildings next week. Full plate for each on the pages that follow.

TOWERS

10

1



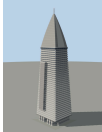
Seagram Curtain Wall
intl

2



Zoning Setback Tower
ziggurat

3



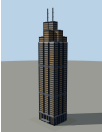
Tapered Spire
pyramid

4



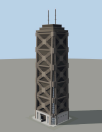
Radiator Crown
sunburst

5



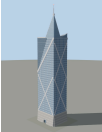
Bundled Tube
bundled

6



Braced Tube
megabrace

7



Faceted Prism
faceted

8



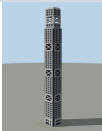
Cathedral of Commerce
neogothic

9



Broken Pediment
postmodern

10



Supertall Slim
pencil

BLOCKS · MID-RISE

10

11



Chicago Loft
brick

12



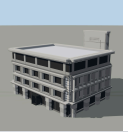
Ashlar Bank
stone

13



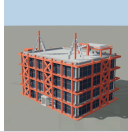
Deco Tower
artdeco

14



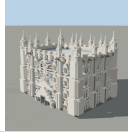
Beton Brut
brutalist

15



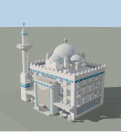
Exostructure
hightech

16



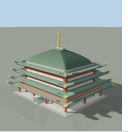
Gothic Revival
gothic

17



Grand Mosque
mosque

18



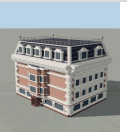
Tiered Eaves
pagoda

19



Pueblo Adobe
adobe

20



Second Empire
victorian

HOUSES

11

21



Queen Anne Painted Lady
queenanne

22



Greek Revival Mansion
greekrev

23



Antebellum Plantation House
plantation

24



English Manor
manor

25



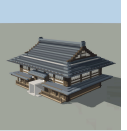
Brick Colonial House
brickhouse

26



Spanish Colonial Mansion
spanish

27



Japanese Residence
machiya

28



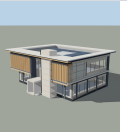
Roman Villa
romanvilla

29



Desert Modern House
desertmod

30



Modern Tech House
techhouse

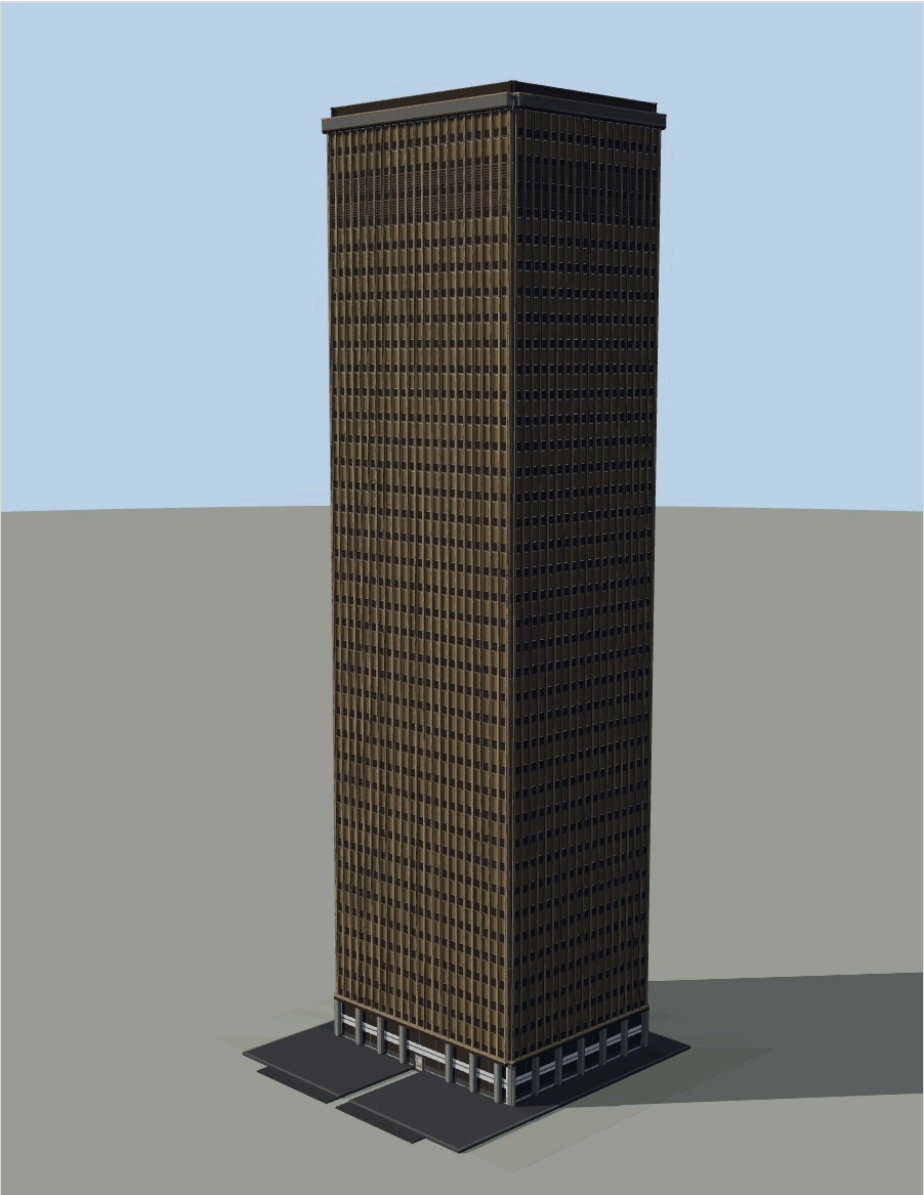
31



Plain House
ranch

1 Seagram Curtain Wall

TOWERS · intl · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Seagram, 1958. Bronze mullions on an absolutely regular grid, a plaza, a lobby set back behind free-standing columns. No ornament anywhere — it survives on proportion alone.

AS A CITY: A corporate downtown. The three siblings are the variations Mies's imitators made: travertine spandrels, a black-steel version, a white-marble civic slab.



From the pavement — the entrance

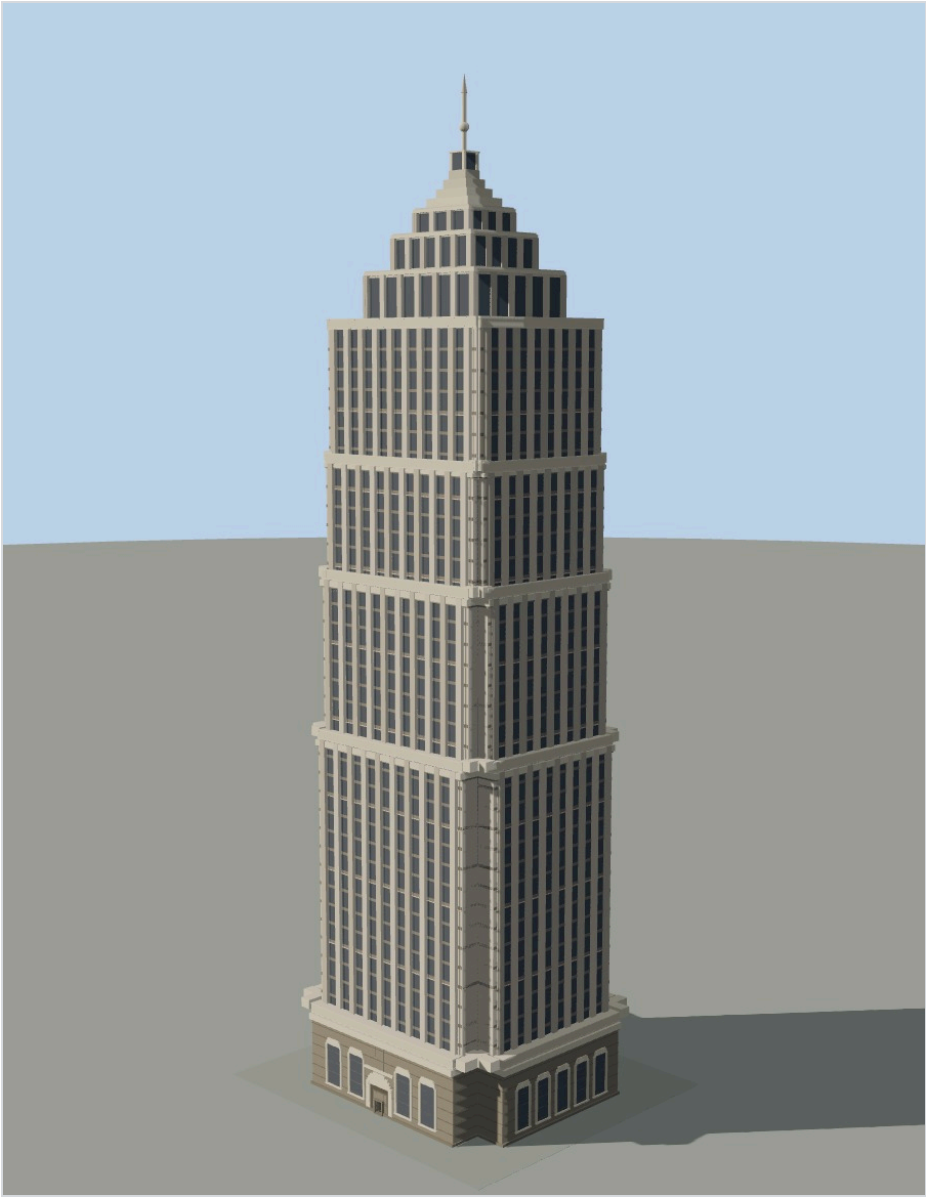


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+3.5 m	Tallest point	131.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	9	Triangles	68,000
Merged deco boxes (free)	5666	Minted meshes (not)	4

2 Zoning Setback Tower

TOWERS · ziggurat · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



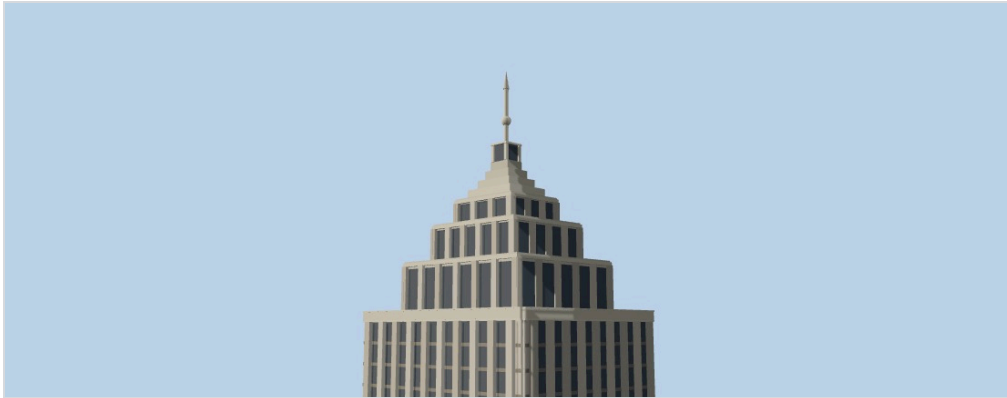
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The 1916 New York zoning envelope: mandatory setbacks stepping the tower back from the street as it rises, so the shape is a law made visible.

AS A CITY: Pre-war Manhattan. Siblings: the wedding-cake hotel, the setback courthouse, the stepped power-company HQ.



From the pavement — the entrance

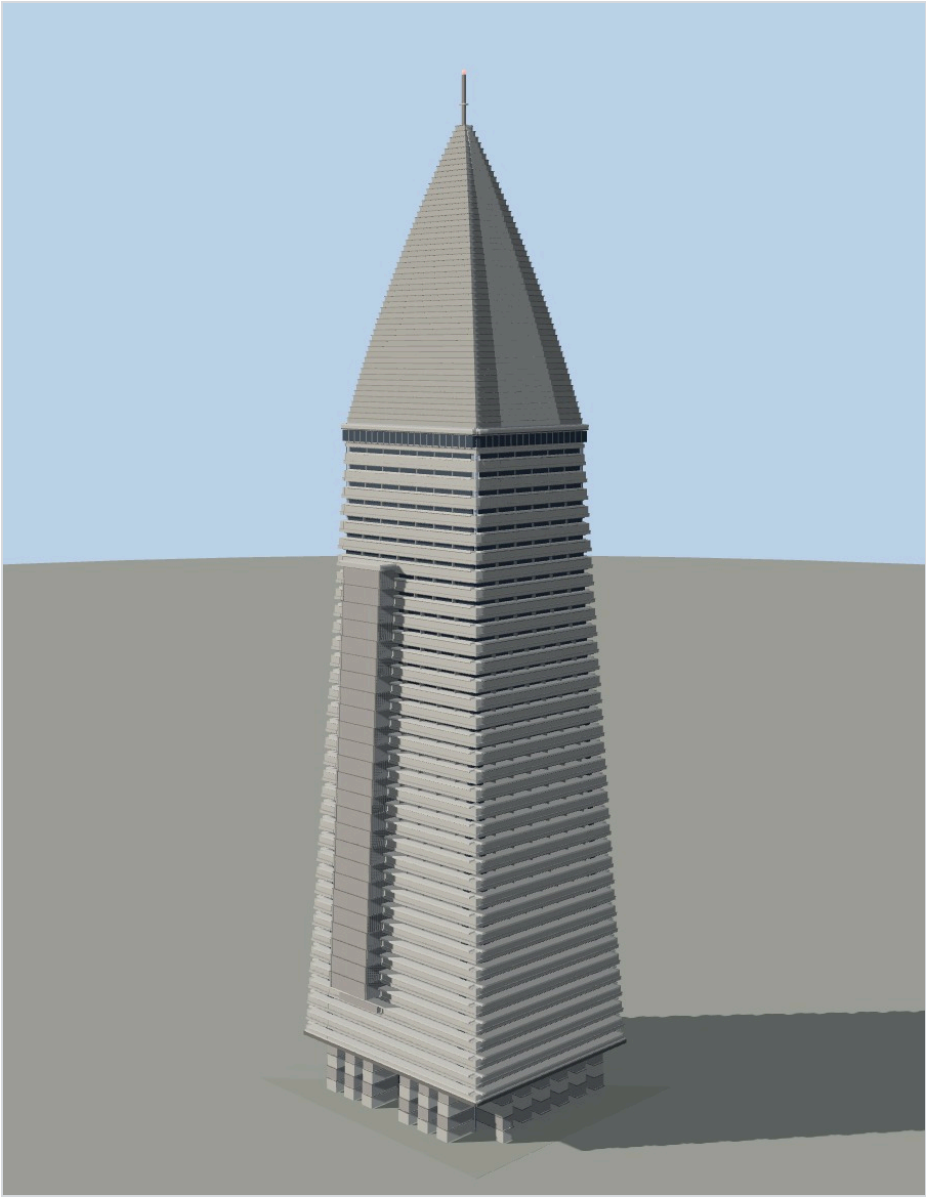


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+40.5 m	Tallest point	168.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	17	Triangles	69,134
Merged deco boxes (free)	5745	Minted meshes (not)	3

3 Tapered Spire

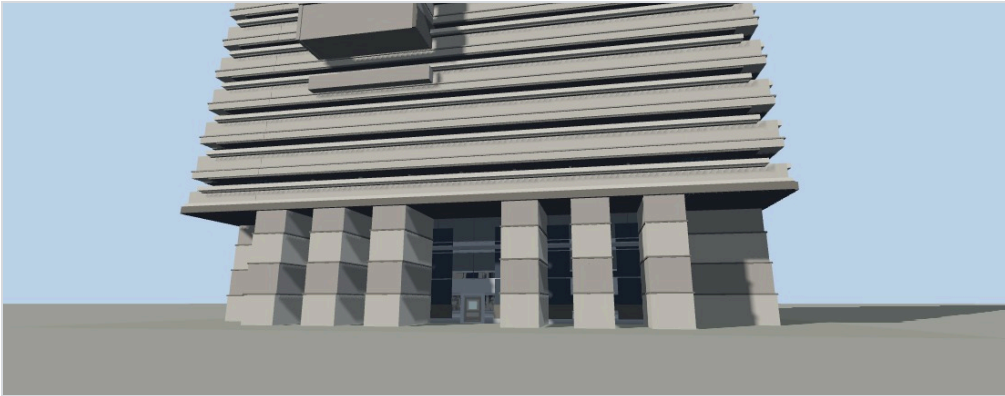
TOWERS · pyramid · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



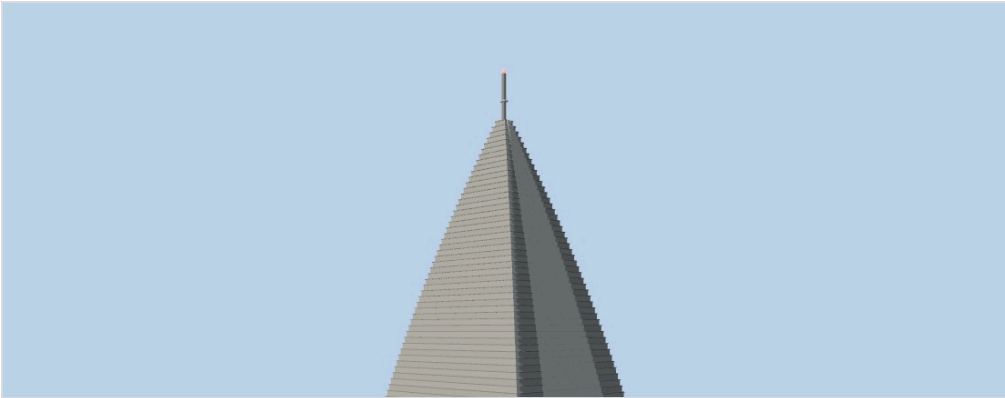
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Transamerica. A tapered spire with the whole elevation converging on a point, wing buttresses at the shoulders.

AS A CITY: A skyline of tapers — obelisk, needle, stepped cone. Rare and expensive to over-use; one per district.



From the pavement — the entrance

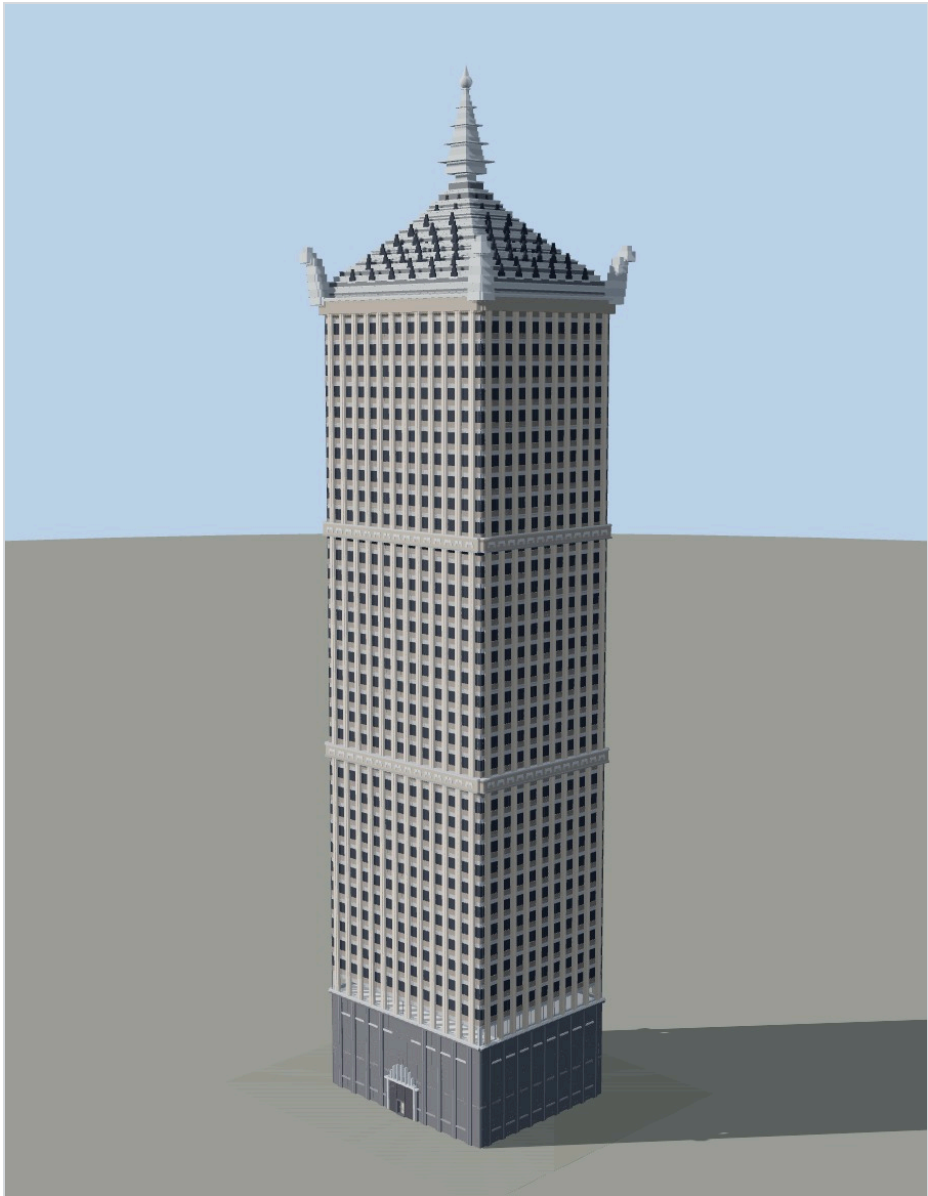


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+64.3 m	Tallest point	192.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	90,712
Merged deco boxes (free)	7546	Minted meshes (not)	2

4 Radiator Crown

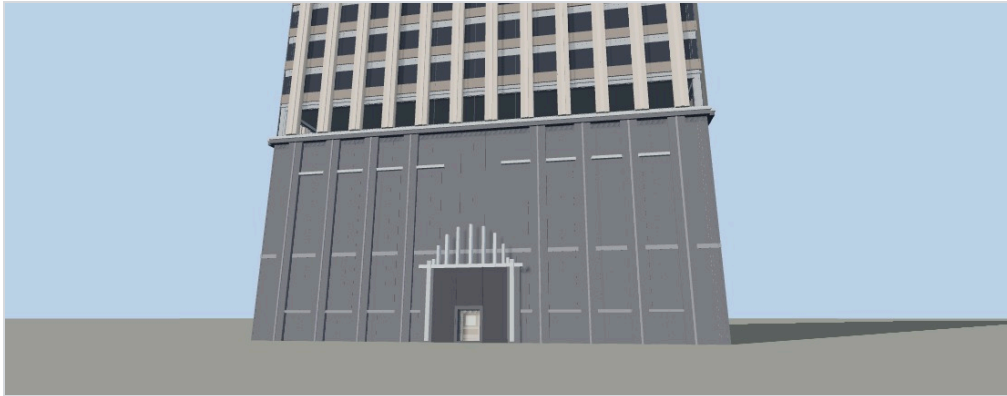
TOWERS · sunburst · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Chrysler's radiator crown: stacked arcs of decreasing radius, dormer eyes, a spire. The crown is the entire building's argument.

AS A CITY: The crown competition of 1930 — every tower in the district trying to out-terminate the last one. The richest sibling set in the kit.



From the pavement — the entrance

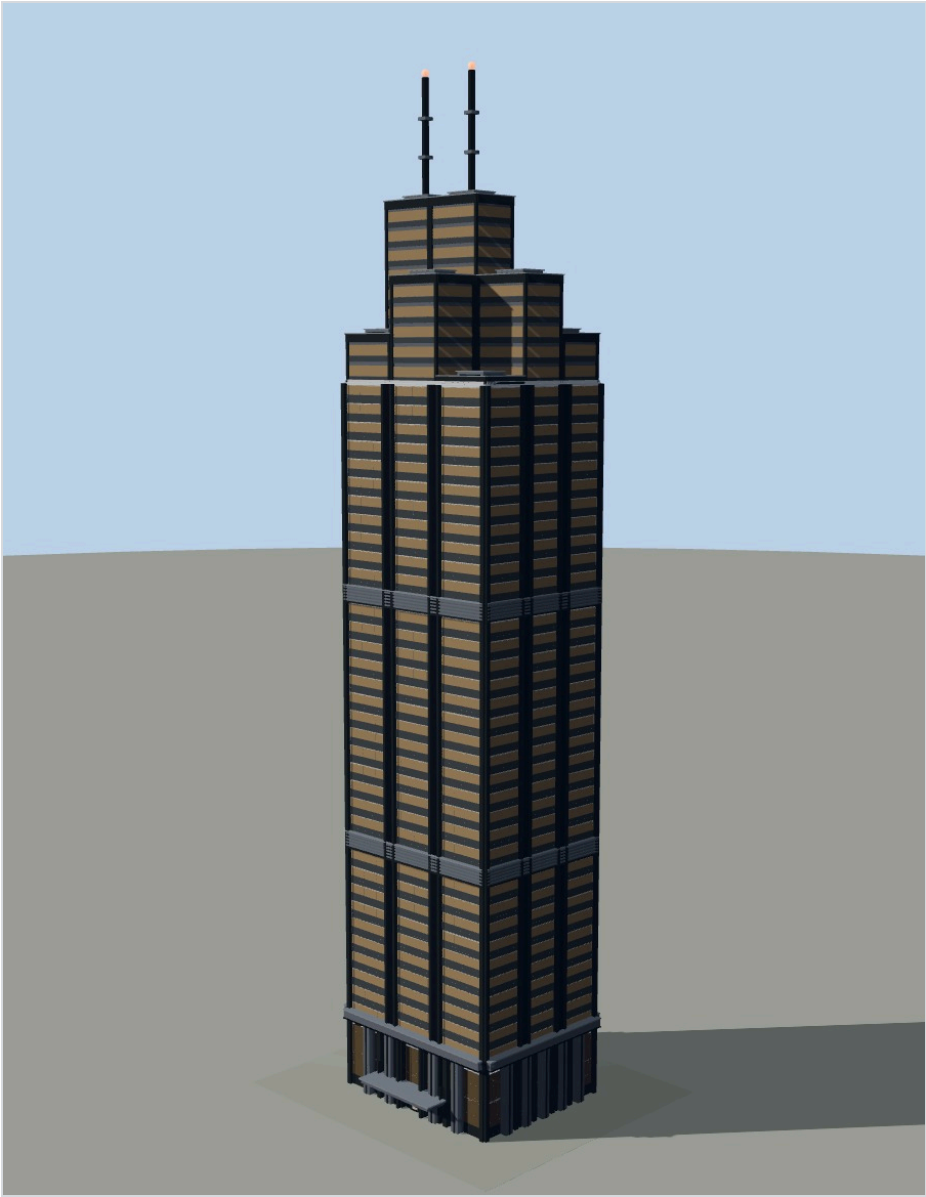


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+35.3 m	Tallest point	163.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	81,858
Merged deco boxes (free)	6808	Minted meshes (not)	2

5 Bundled Tube

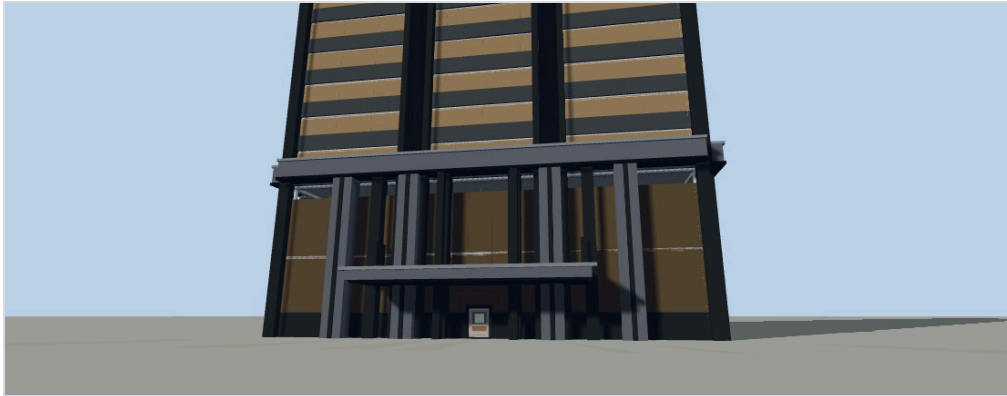
TOWERS · bundled · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



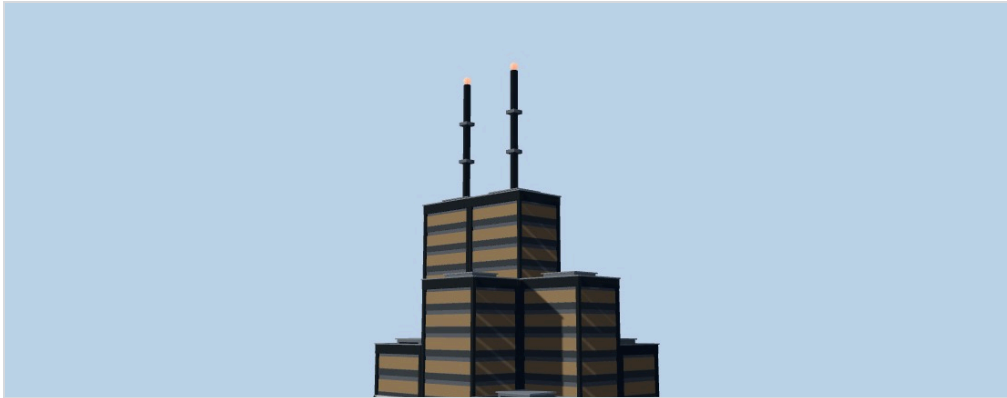
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Sears/Willis. Nine square tubes in a 3x3 bundle that stop at different heights. Almost no surface treatment; pure massing.

AS A CITY: A structural-expression downtown: tube, bundle, diagonal, hat truss. Cold, enormous, recognisable at 20 km.



From the pavement — the entrance

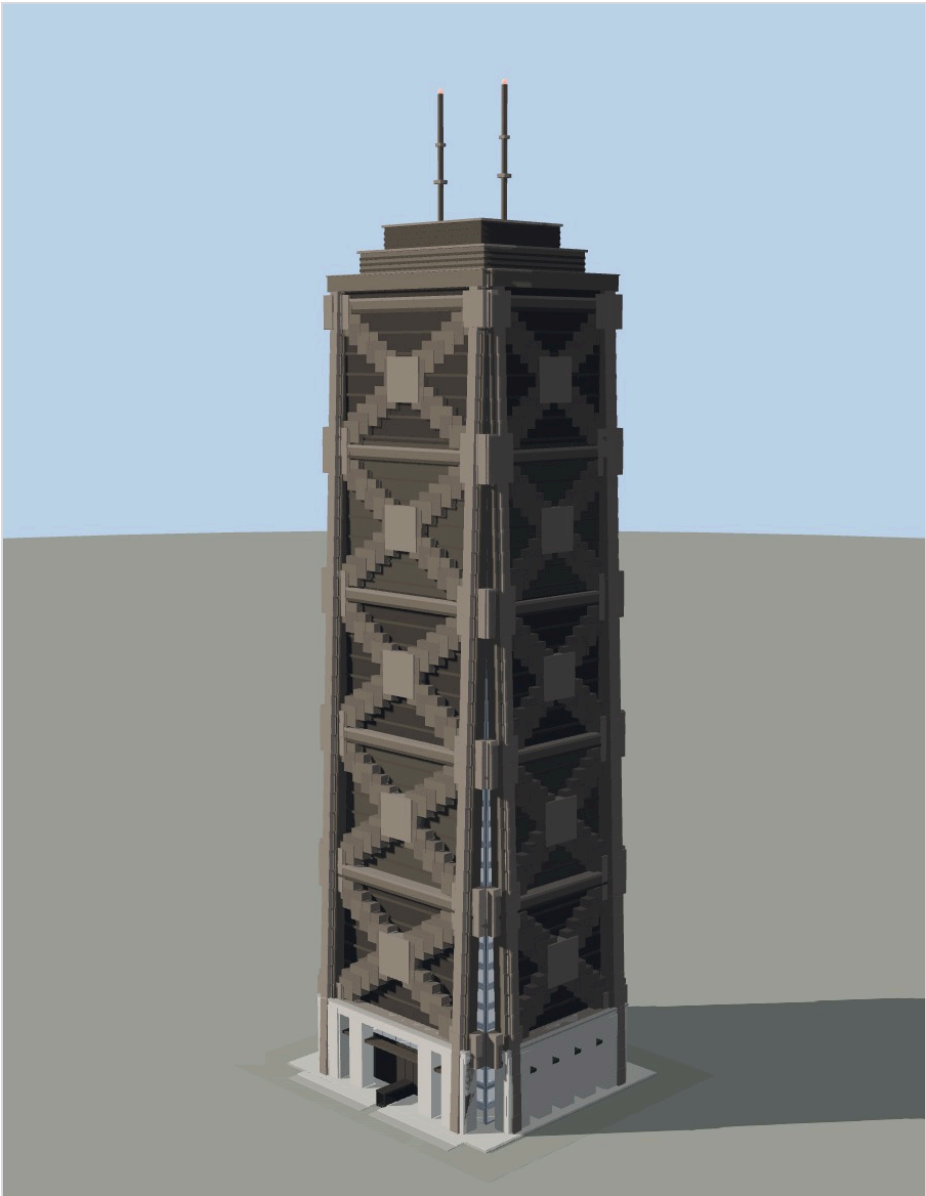


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+54 m	Tallest point	182 m
Things breaking the roofline	16	Triangles	68,756
Merged deco boxes (free)	5711	Minted meshes (not)	4

6 Braced Tube

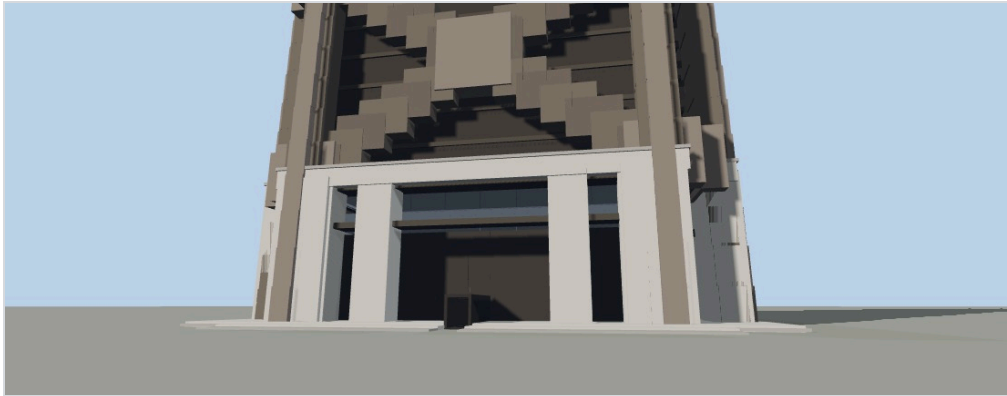
TOWERS · megabrace · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The braced tube — giant X-bracing crossing many storeys on the outside of the glass, structure as the only ornament.

AS A CITY: Siblings: the diagrid, the outrigger belt truss, the exposed mega-column. An engineer's city.



From the pavement — the entrance

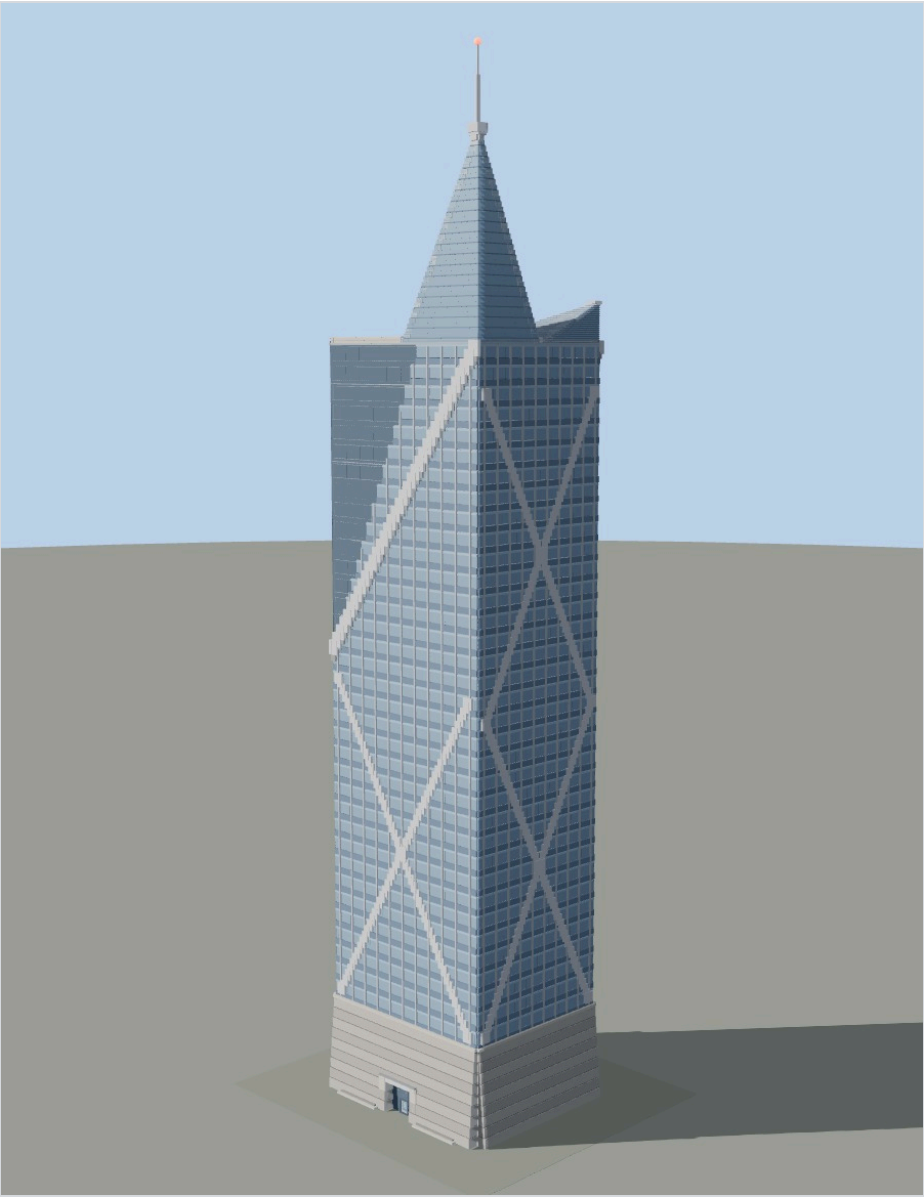


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+31.5 m	Tallest point	159.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	12	Triangles	77,336
Merged deco boxes (free)	6426	Minted meshes (not)	4

7 Faceted Prism

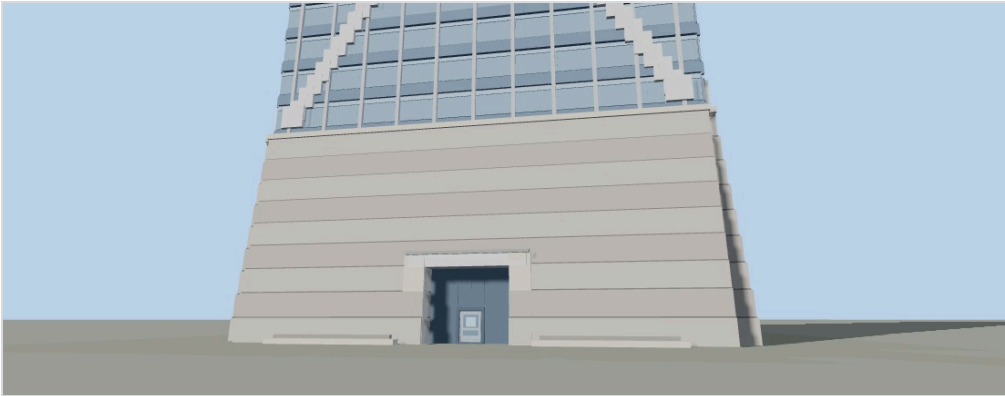
TOWERS · faceted · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Bank of China, 1990. The prism is CUT: quadrants rise to four different heights with long diagonals running across dozens of storeys.

AS A CITY: A crystal district. Siblings are the other cuts — the sheared top, the twisted shaft, the folded plate.



From the pavement — the entrance

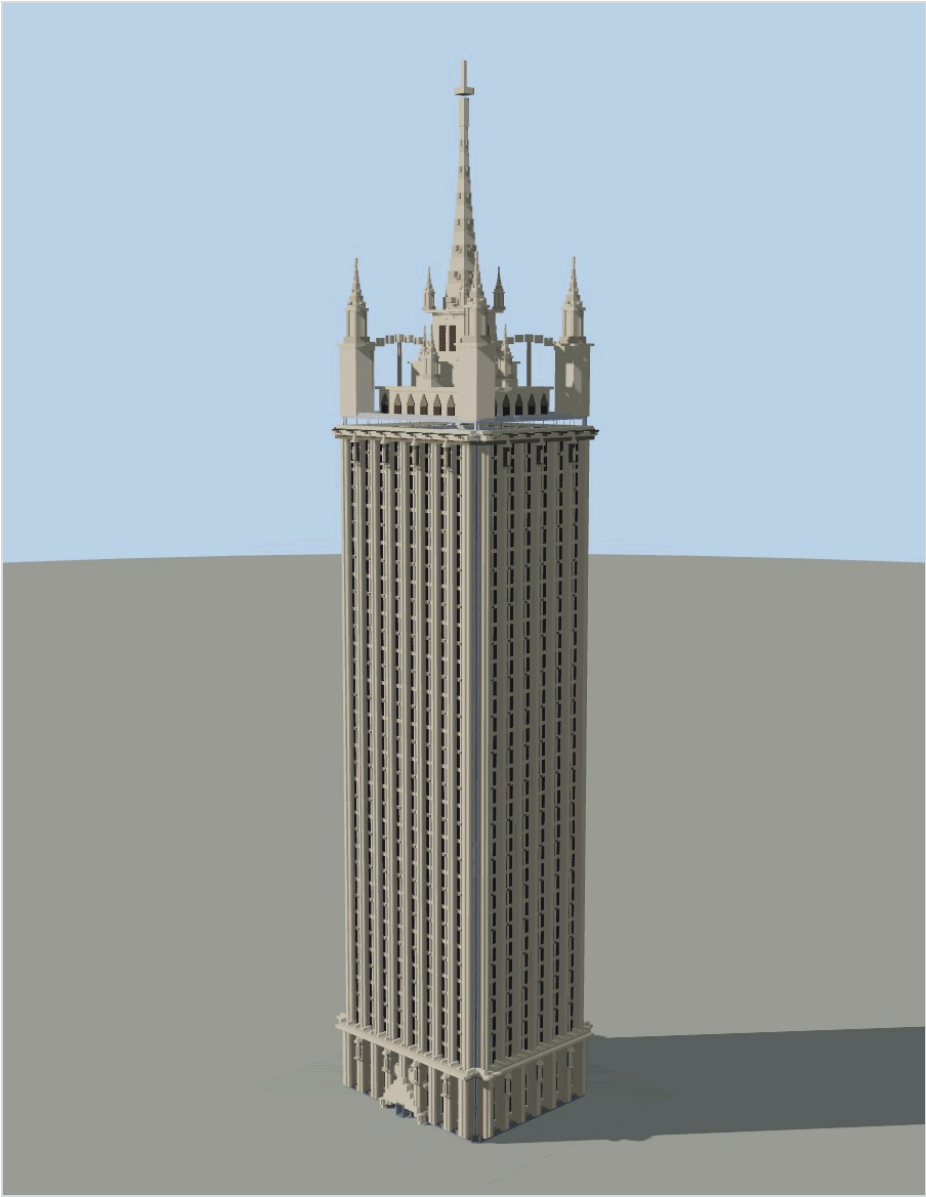


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+44.8 m	Tallest point	172.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	47	Triangles	77,260
Merged deco boxes (free)	6427	Minted meshes (not)	3

8 Cathedral of Commerce

TOWERS · neogothic · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Woolworth, the Cathedral of Commerce: a Gothic cathedral stretched to 60 storeys, buttresses and pinnacles all the way up.

AS A CITY: The 1913 skyline where every tower borrowed a cathedral. Siblings: Tribune Tower's flying buttresses, a spired campanile, a Gothic crown on a stone shaft.



From the pavement — the entrance



The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+62.3 m	Tallest point	190.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	10	Triangles	100,152
Merged deco boxes (free)	8346	Minted meshes (not)	0

9 Broken Pediment

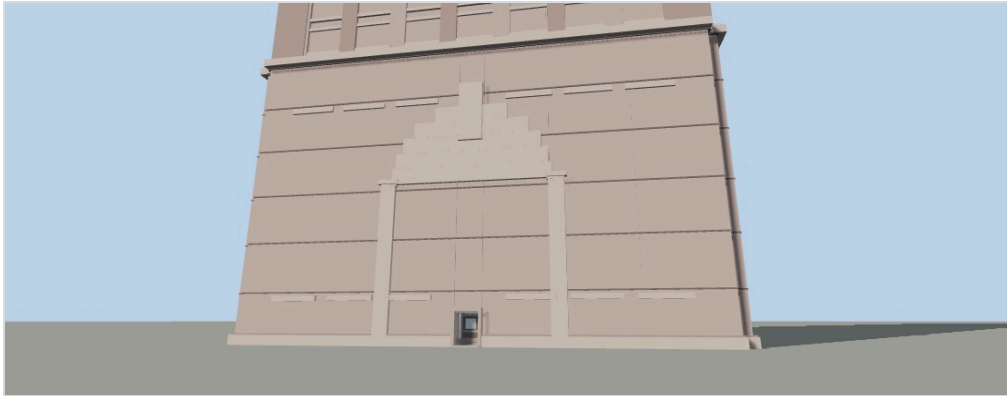
TOWERS · postmodern · 34×28 M, 40 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

AT&T, 1984. A classical broken pediment on top of a skyscraper — deliberately absurd, deliberately memorable.

AS A CITY: The 1980s. Siblings: the Chippendale sibling, the pink granite arch, the temple-front bank. A city with a sense of humour.



From the pavement — the entrance

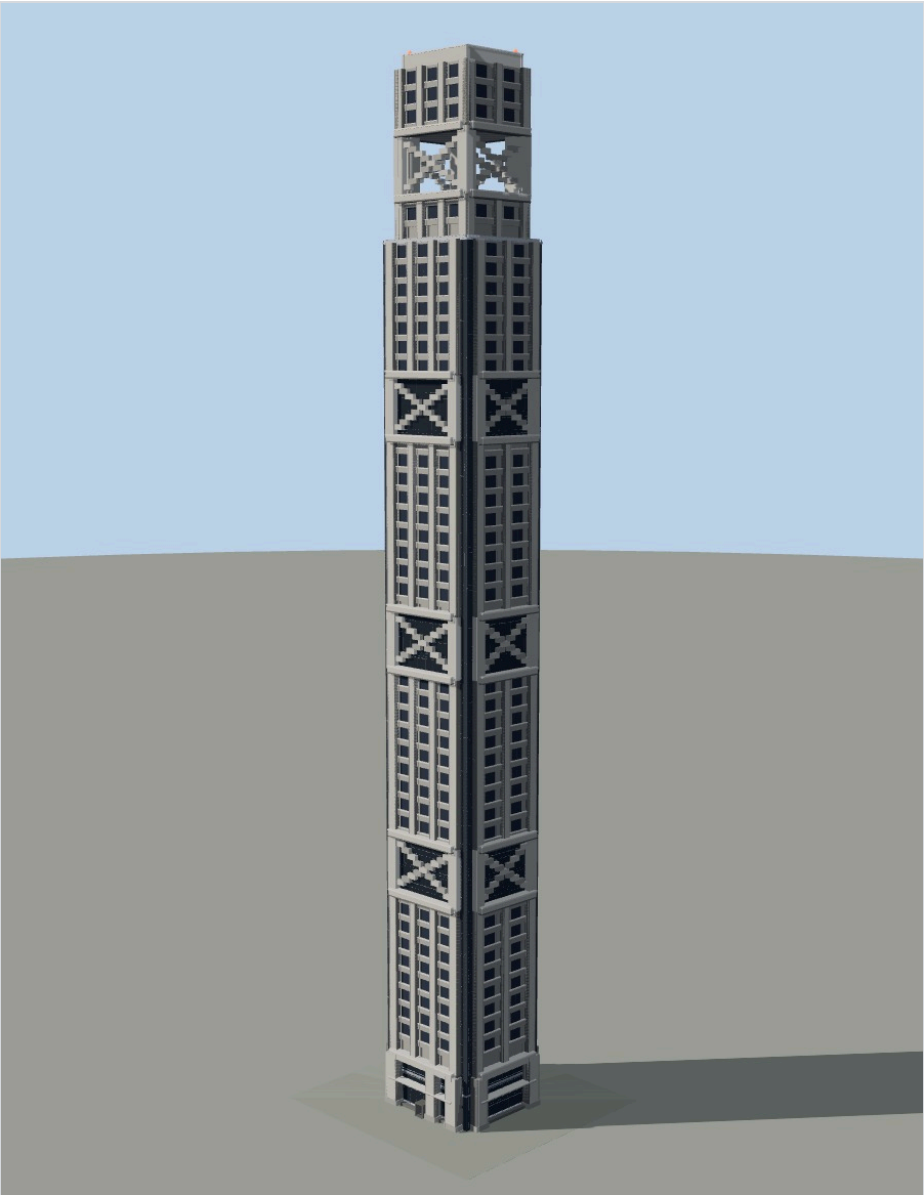


The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+14.5 m	Tallest point	142.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	99,300
Merged deco boxes (free)	8275	Minted meshes (not)	0

10 Supertall Slim

TOWERS · pencil · 20×18 M, 48 STOREYS (SLIM PLAN — THIS GRAMMAR'S OWN)



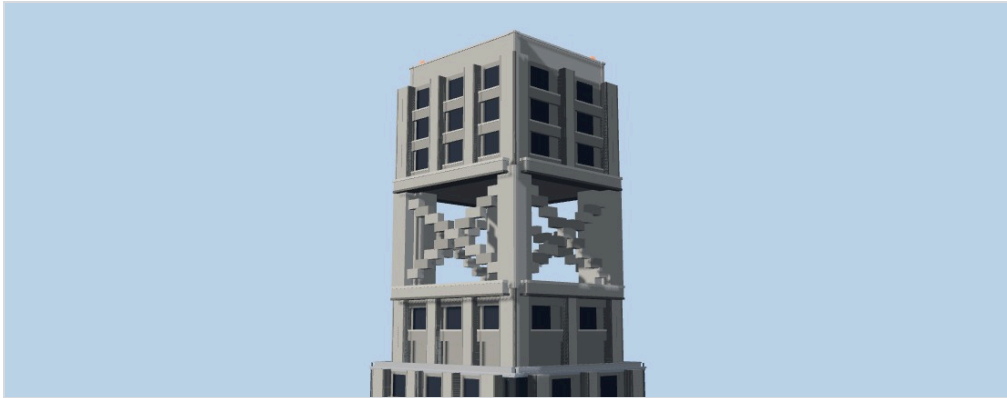
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The supertall slim: a 1:12 shaft, open mechanical floors punched through it for wind, a razor top.

AS A CITY: Billionaires' Row. Siblings: the setback needle, the concrete-core stack, the paired-tower slot. A city of impossibly thin things.



From the pavement — the entrance



The crown — the whole identity at skyline distance

Crown above the bare shell	+31.9 m	Tallest point	185.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	13	Triangles	86,440
Merged deco boxes (free)	7190	Minted meshes (not)	2

11 Chicago Loft

BLOCKS · MID-RISE · brick · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



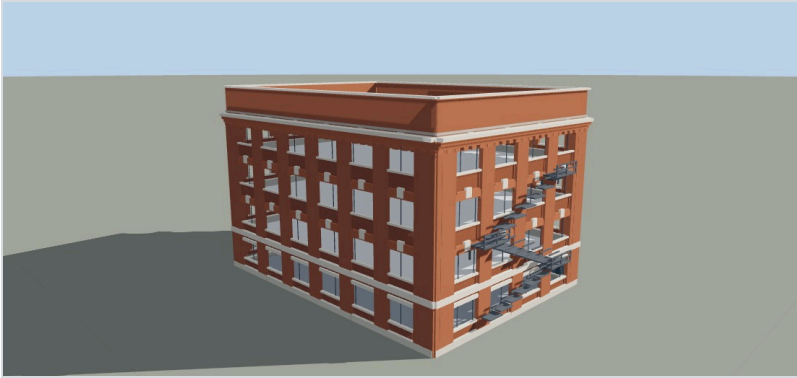
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Chicago loft, c.1905. Load-bearing brick read as STRUCTURE: piers between the bays, segmental arches, a corbelled cornice, cast-iron storefront, fire escape down the flank.

AS A CITY: A warehouse district that became lofts. Siblings: the mill building, the printing house, the brick-and-timber garment block.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+2.2 m	Tallest point	15 m
Things breaking the roofline	8	Triangles	17,424
Merged deco boxes (free)	1452	Minted meshes (not)	0

12 Ashlar Bank

BLOCKS · MID-RISE · stone · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



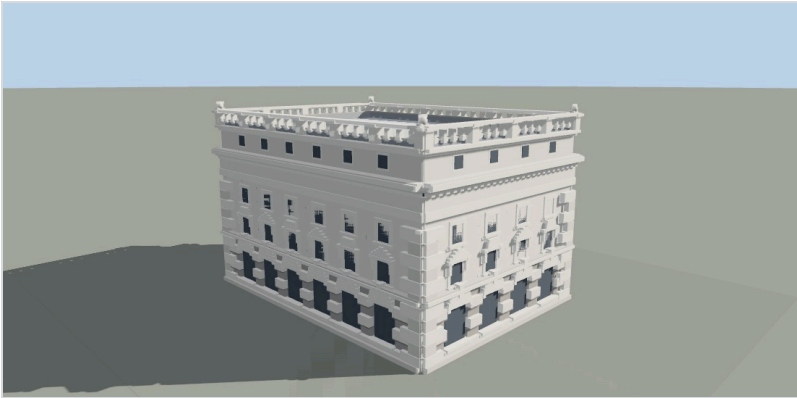
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Ashlar bank in three parts — rusticated base, plain shaft, attic over a heavy cornice — with a giant order solved backwards from the roofline.

AS A CITY: A financial quarter of stone institutions: the exchange, the courthouse, the trust company, the library.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.9 m	Tallest point	14.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	10	Triangles	23,256
Merged deco boxes (free)	1870	Minted meshes (not)	10

13 Deco Tower

BLOCKS · MID-RISE · artdeco · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



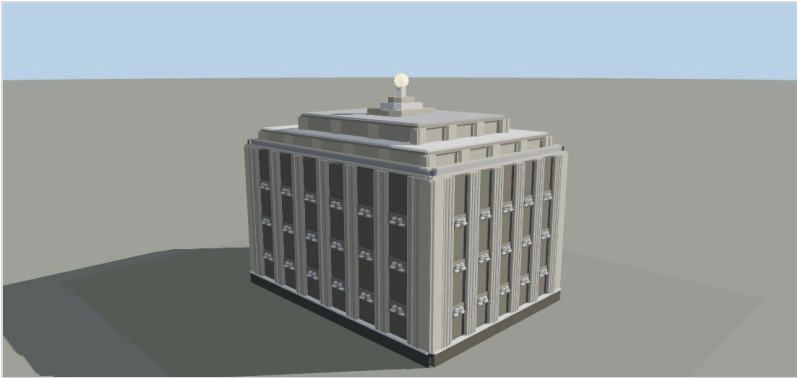
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

1930 setback commercial block. Fluted piers run base to crown with the spandrels pushed back behind them; nothing horizontal is allowed to cross a pier.

AS A CITY: A whole deco main street: theatre, department store, telephone exchange, hotel.



From the pavement — the entrance

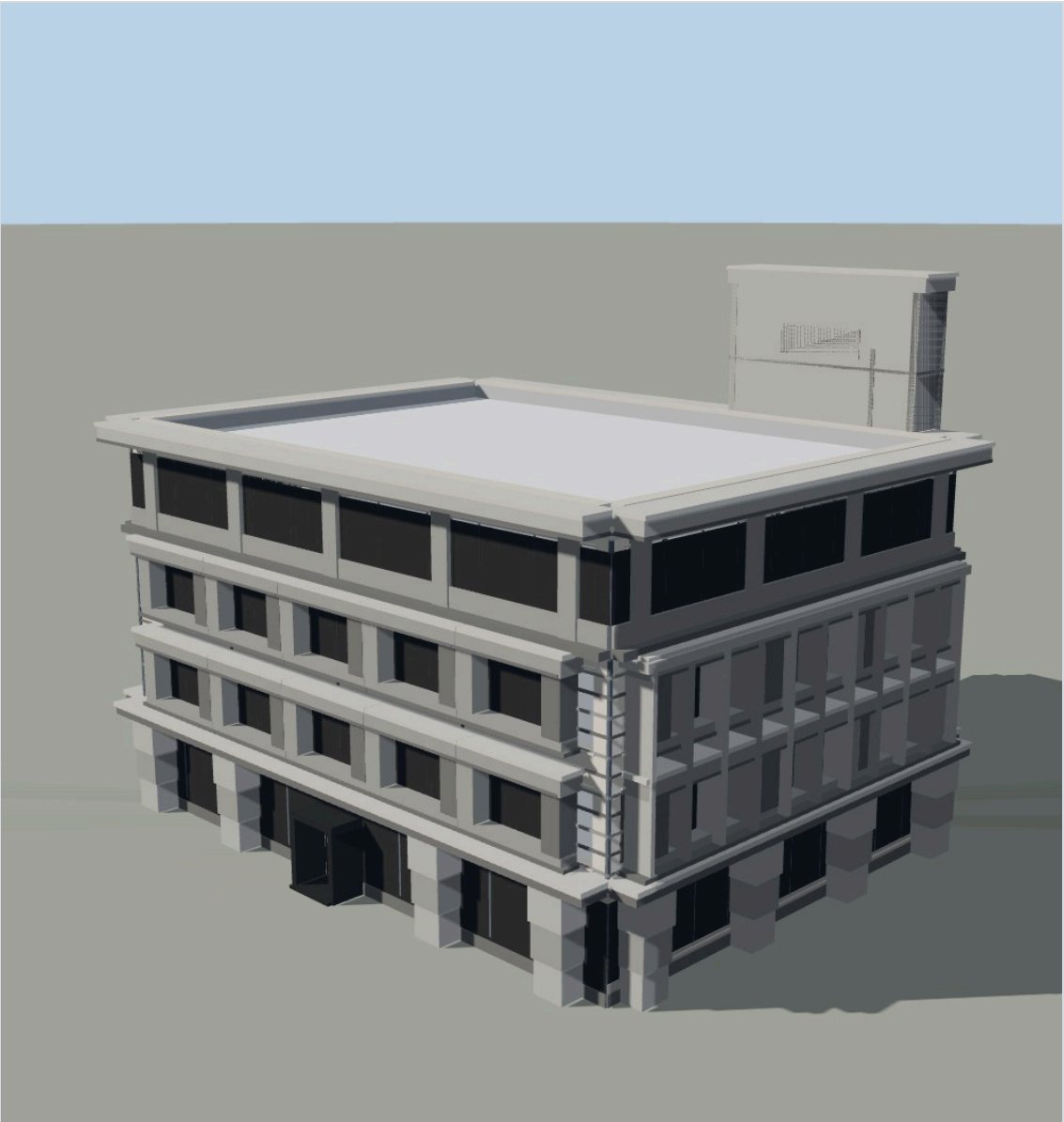


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+6.5 m	Tallest point	19.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	13	Triangles	14,588
Merged deco boxes (free)	1209	Minted meshes (not)	1

14 Beton Brut

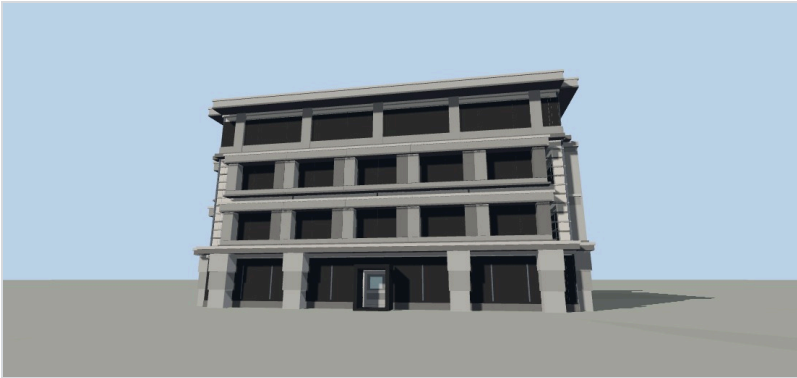
BLOCKS · MID-RISE · brutalist · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



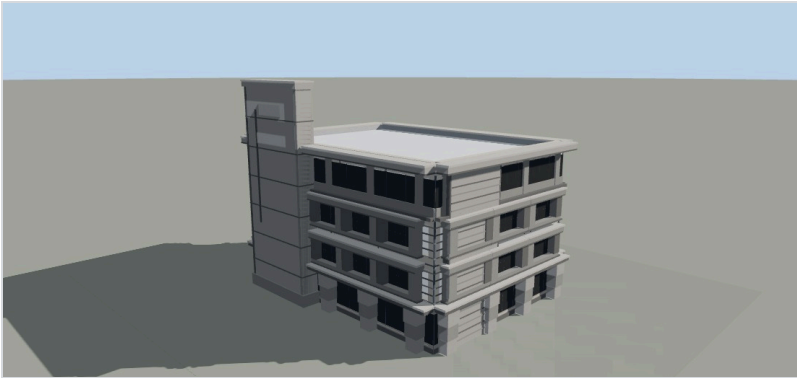
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Beton brut. Every opening a hole punched through a thick wall, hooded so it throws a hard shadow all day; board-formed plank lines; lifted on pilotis.

AS A CITY: A concrete civic campus — city hall, the library, the parking structure, the housing slab. Grim and coherent.



From the pavement — the entrance

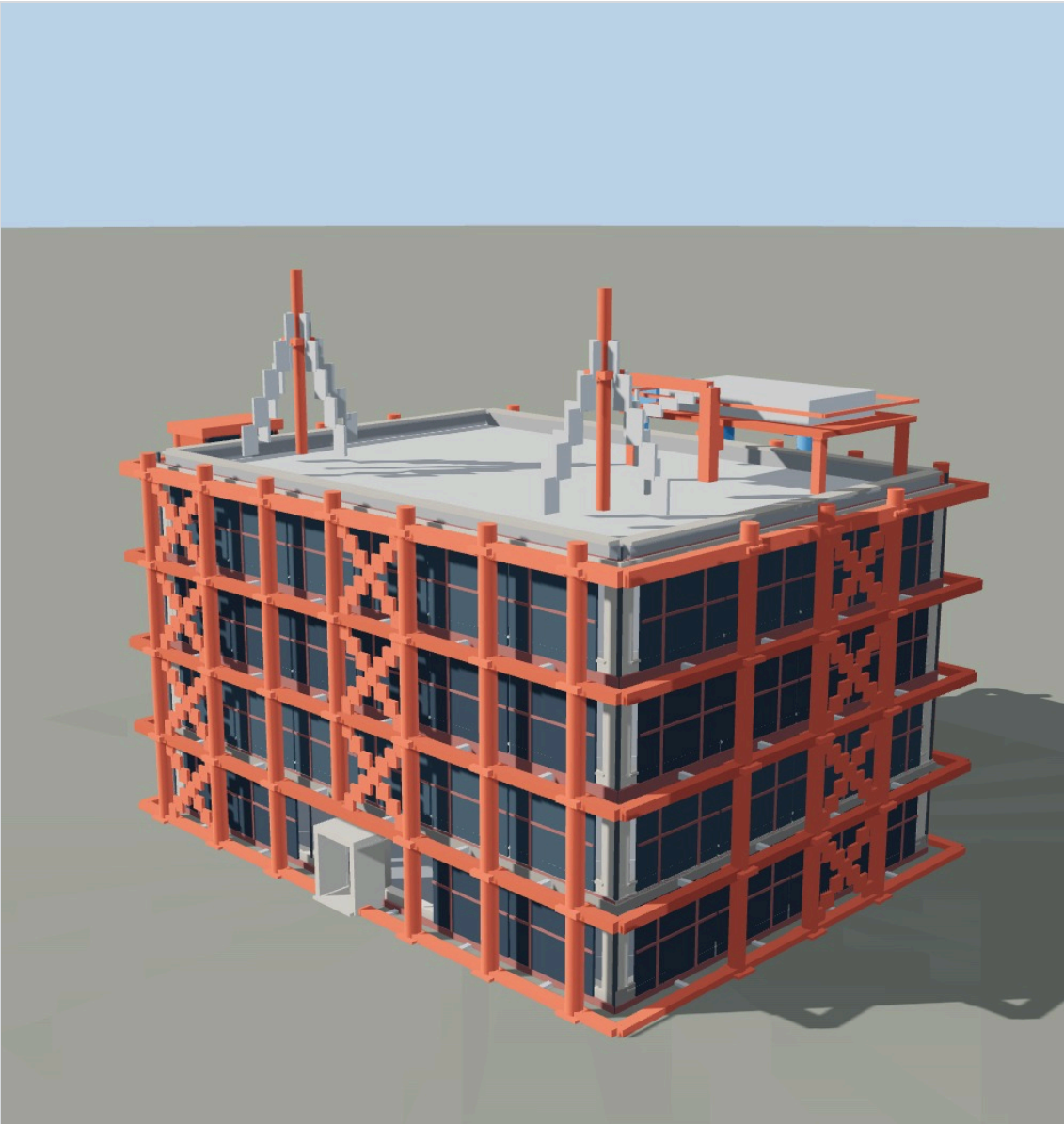


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+5.7 m	Tallest point	18.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	11	Triangles	11,748
Merged deco boxes (free)	979	Minted meshes (not)	0

15 Exostructure

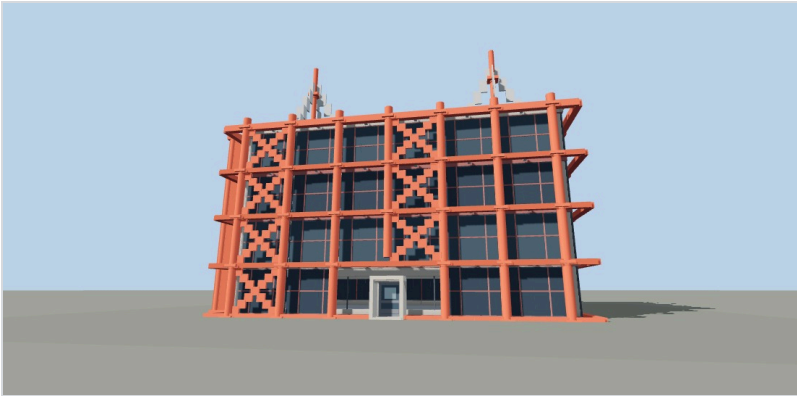
BLOCKS · MID-RISE · hightech · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



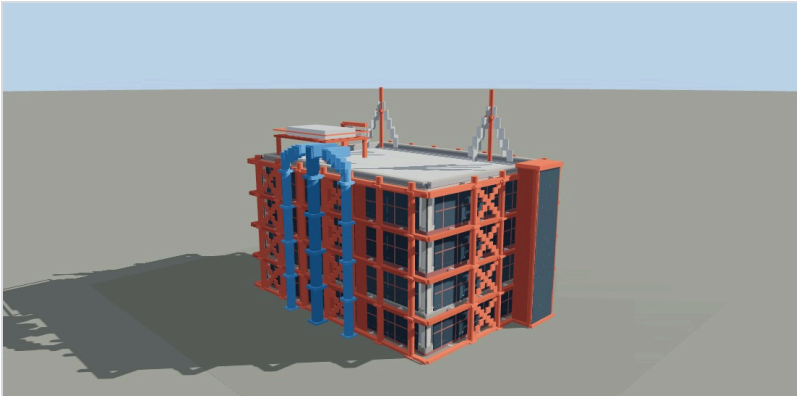
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Inside-out, Lloyd's / Pompidou: the frame stands proud of the glass, the risers and stair are outside, and the roof plant is architecture.

AS A CITY: A services-on-the-outside quarter. Siblings: the exposed-truss shed, the tension-rod atrium, the gantry-served lab.



From the pavement — the entrance

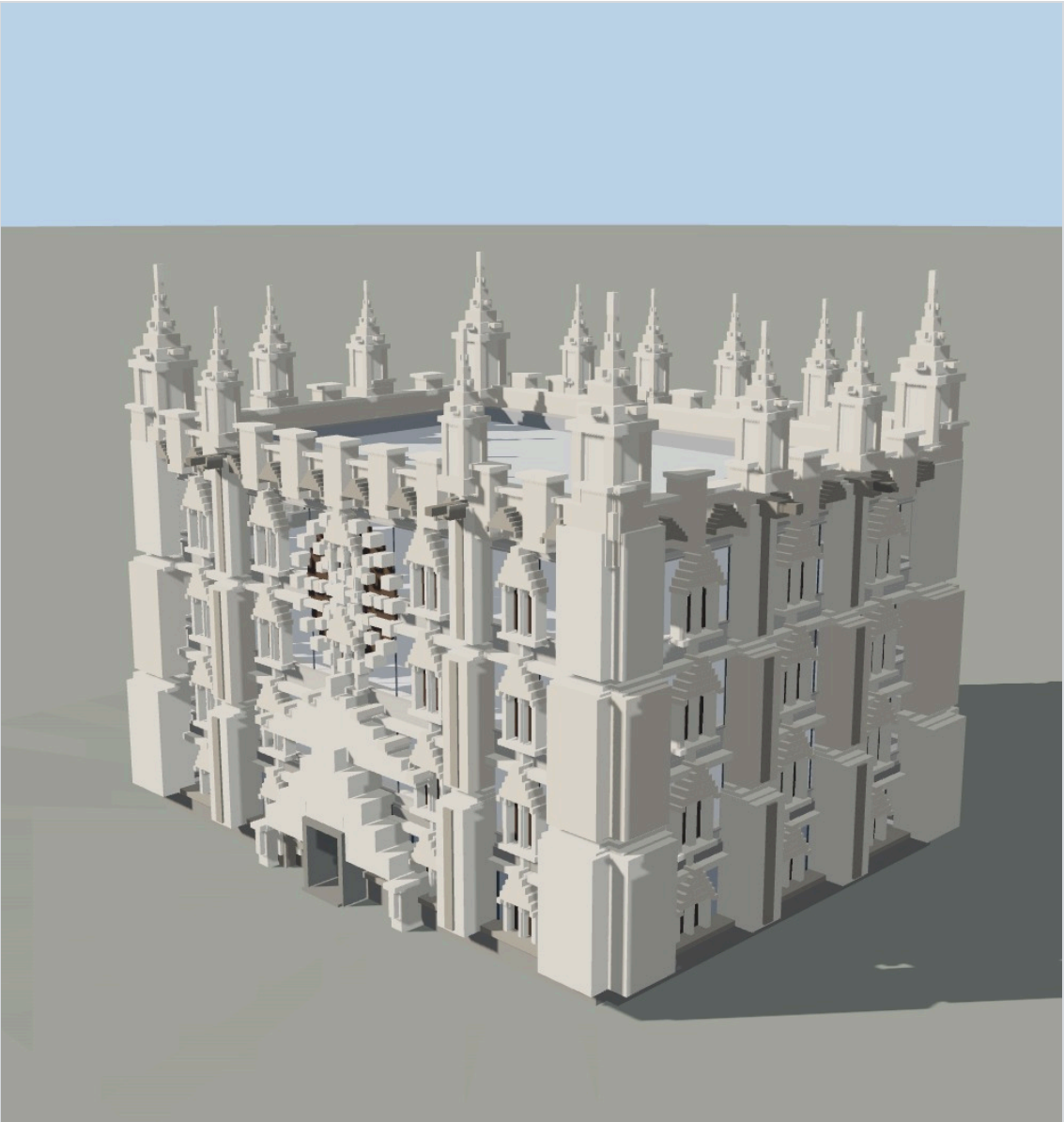


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+7 m	Tallest point	19.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	39	Triangles	19,316
Merged deco boxes (free)	1521	Minted meshes (not)	27

16 Gothic Revival

BLOCKS · MID-RISE · gothic · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



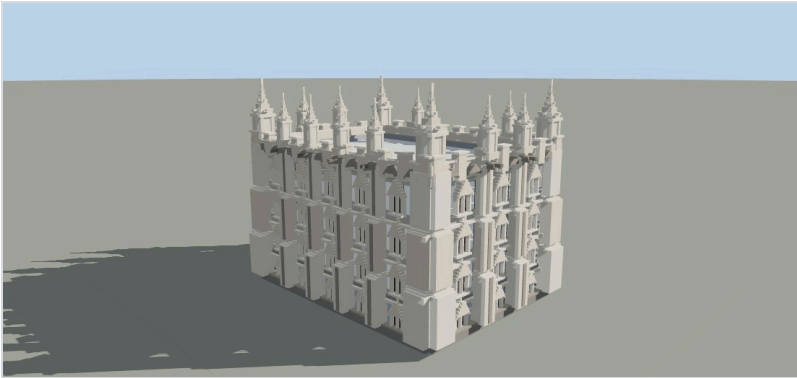
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Gothic Revival civic front: buttresses stepping back as they rise, pinnacles breaking the roofline, tracery, a rose window over a deep portal. Everything ends in a point.

AS A CITY: An old-world cathedral town — the hall, the guild, the college quad, the parish church.



From the pavement — the entrance

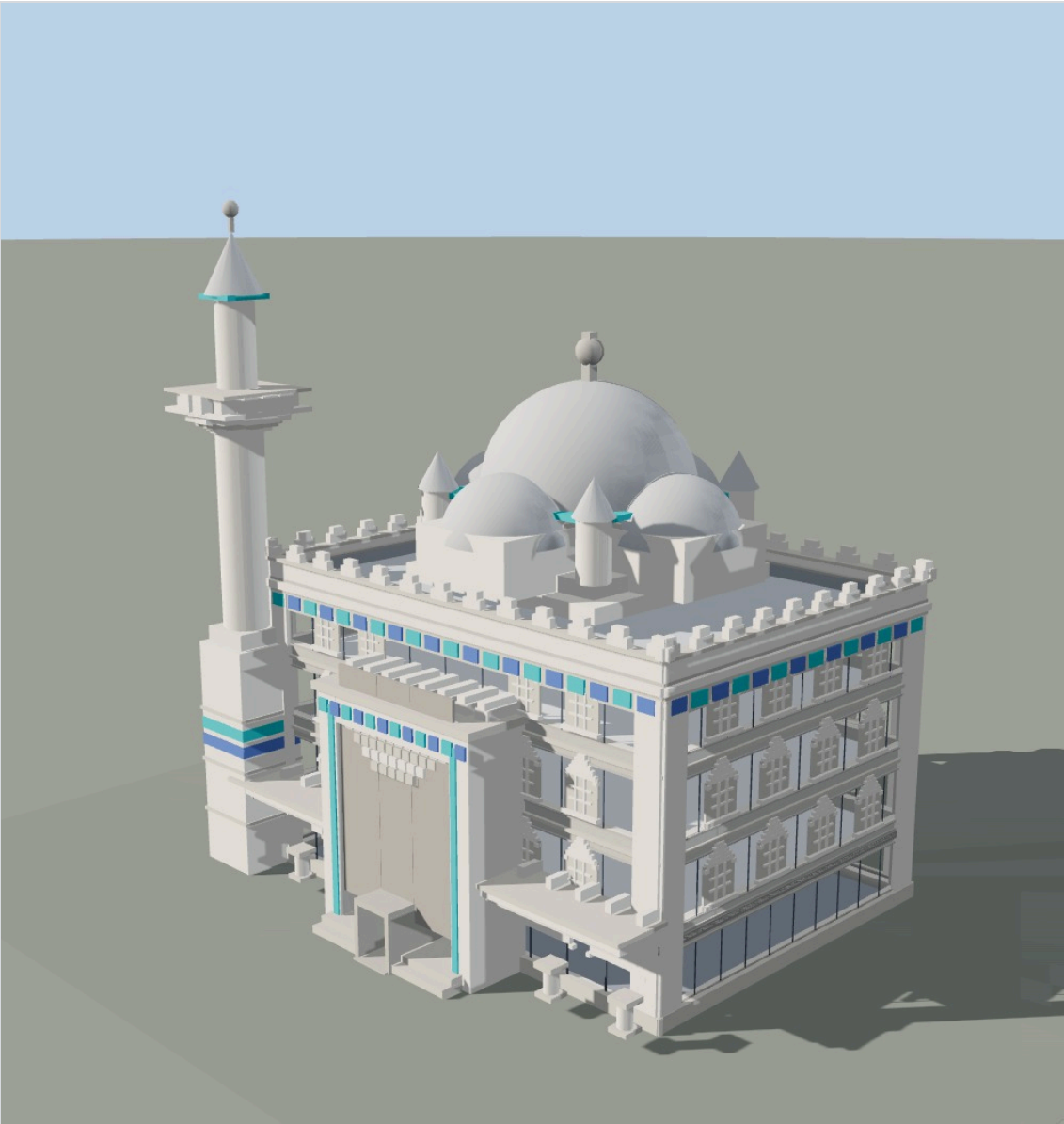


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+7 m	Tallest point	19.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	9	Triangles	55,176
Merged deco boxes (free)	4598	Minted meshes (not)	0

17 Grand Mosque

BLOCKS · MID-RISE · mosque · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Dome on a buttressed drum, a minaret off one corner, horseshoe arcade, monumental pishtaq portal.

AS A CITY: An Islamic old city: the great mosque, the madrasa, the caravanserai, the covered bazaar. Big cultural payoff.



From the pavement — the entrance

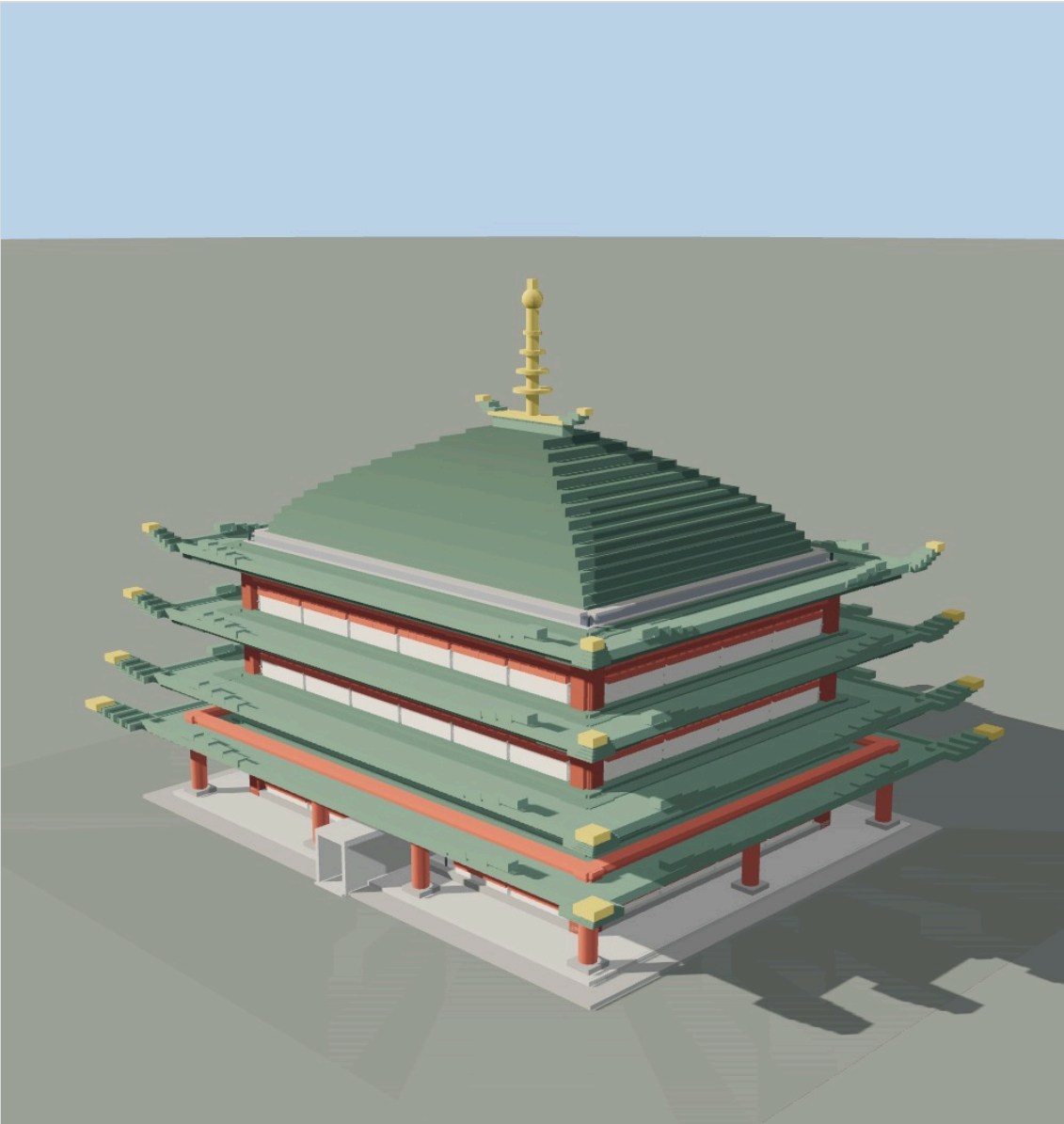


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+16 m	Tallest point	28.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	28	Triangles	22,602
Merged deco boxes (free)	1645	Minted meshes (not)	25

18 Tiered Eaves

BLOCKS · MID-RISE · pagoda · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



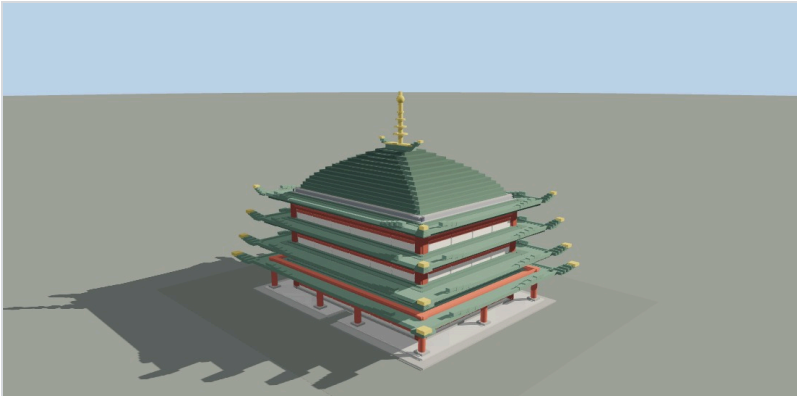
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Timber frame under deep tiered eaves with upturned corners on visible dougong brackets. The lowest eave projects the furthest.

AS A CITY: An East Asian temple quarter: gate, hall, drum tower, pagoda proper.



From the pavement — the entrance

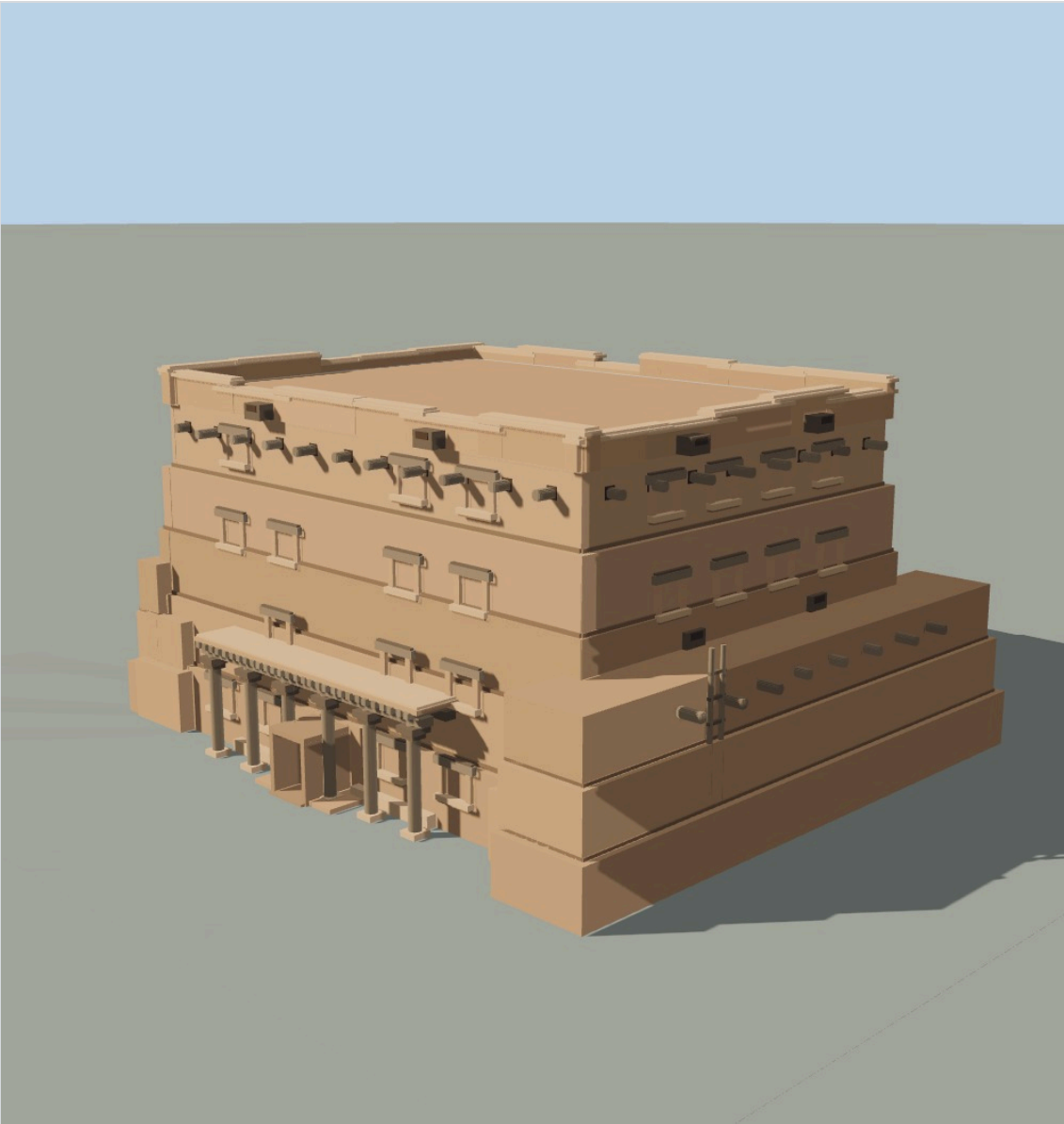


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+12.5 m	Tallest point	25.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	27	Triangles	31,068
Merged deco boxes (free)	2527	Minted meshes (not)	16

19 Pueblo Adobe

BLOCKS · MID-RISE · adobe · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



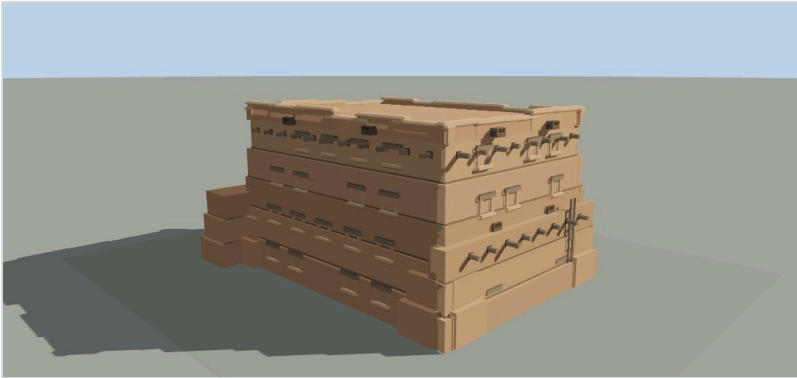
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Earthen mass: battered walls thickening to the base, projecting vigas, stepped massing, small deep-set windows, a latilla porch. Irregularity IS the style.

AS A CITY: A pueblo/Saltlands town — mission church, trading post, stacked terraced dwellings.



From the pavement — the entrance

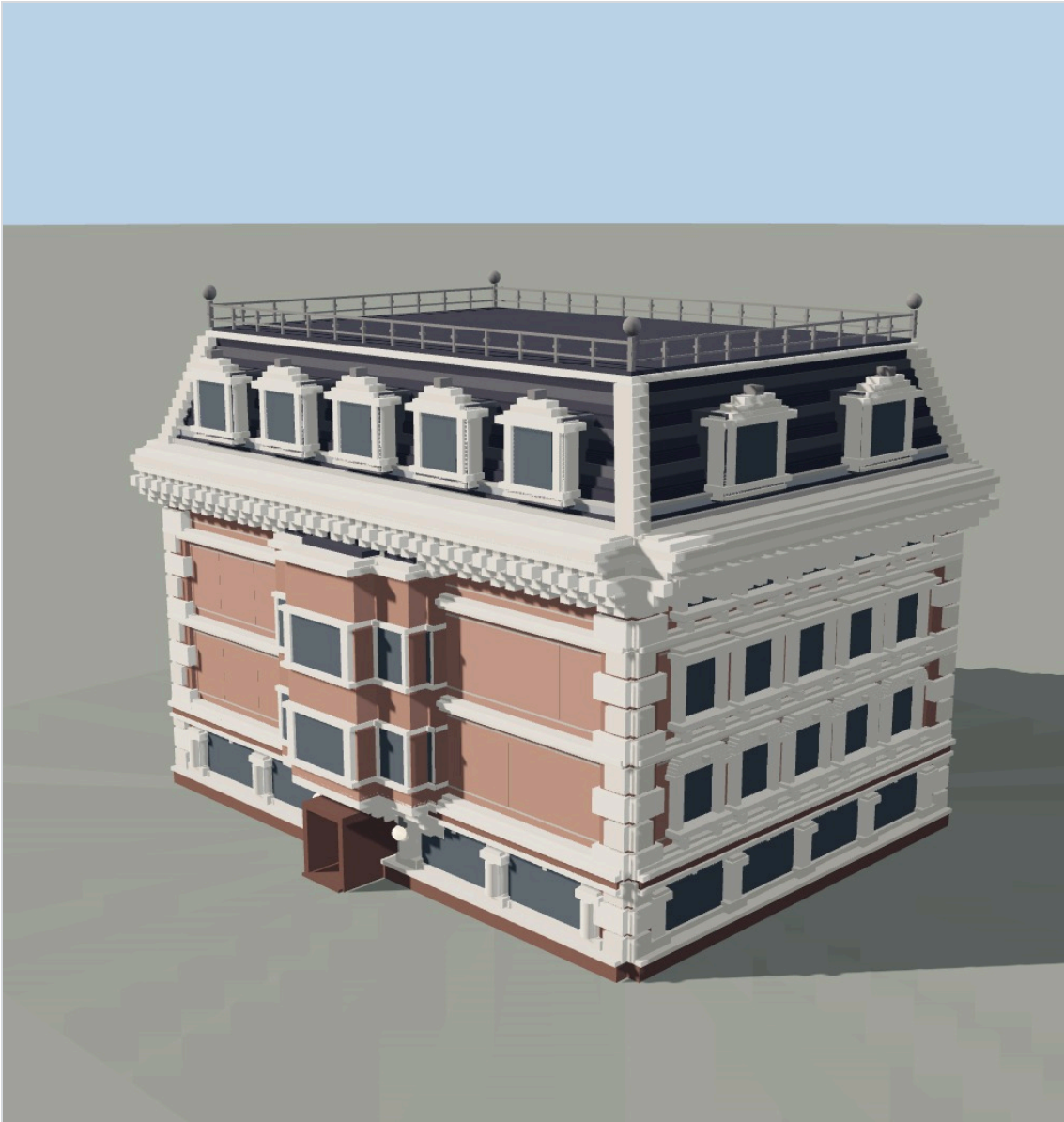


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.7 m	Tallest point	14.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	24	Triangles	16,912
Merged deco boxes (free)	1382	Minted meshes (not)	10

20 Second Empire

BLOCKS · MID-RISE · victorian · 22×16 M, 4 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Second Empire. Mansard roof with dormers punching through, projecting oriel bays, a deep bracketed cornice over a cast-iron storefront.

AS A CITY: A 19th-century downtown: the opera house, the hotel, the department store, the rooming block.



From the pavement — the entrance

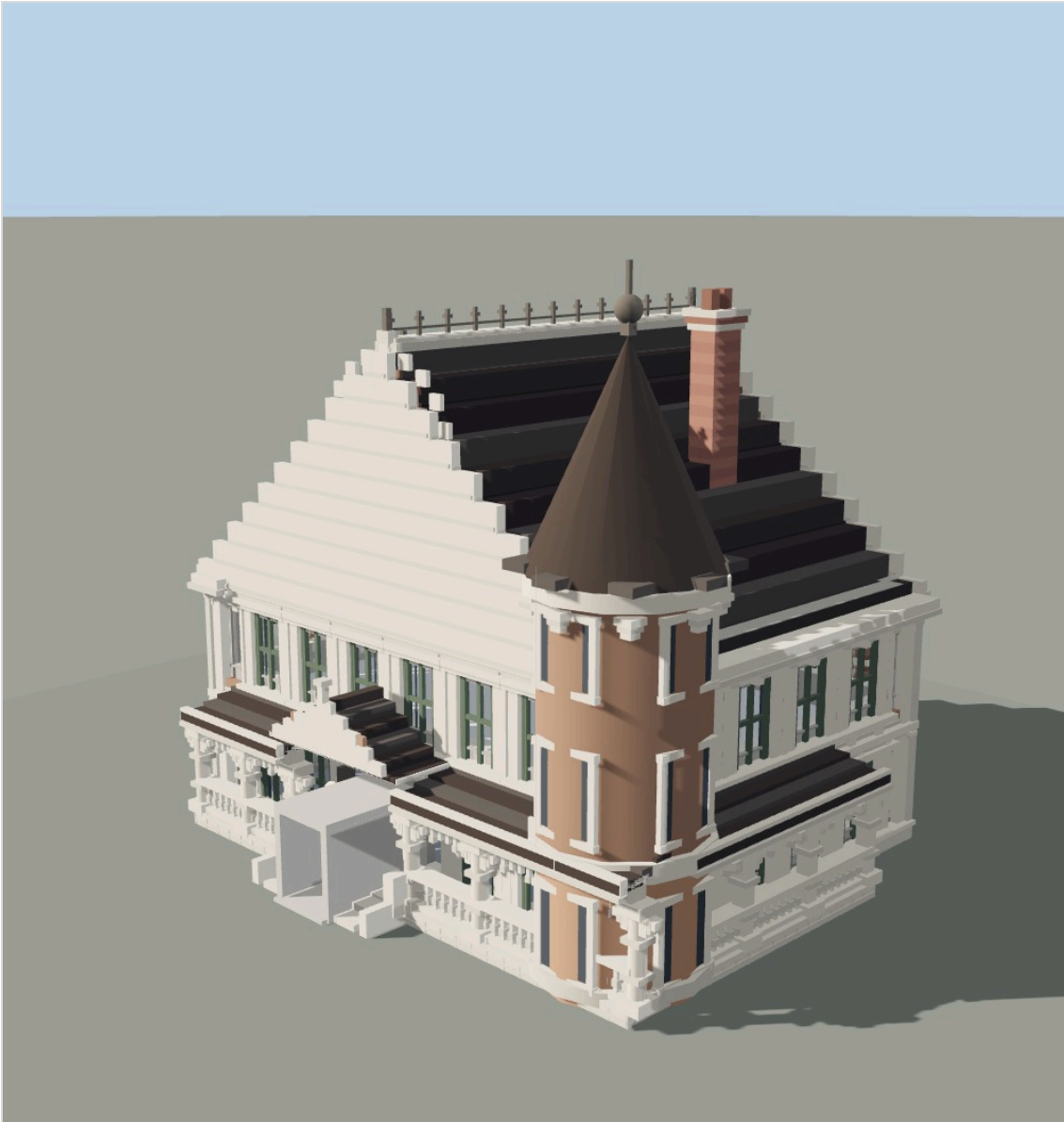


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+5.4 m	Tallest point	18.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	18	Triangles	34,276
Merged deco boxes (free)	2787	Minted meshes (not)	12

21 Queen Anne Painted Lady

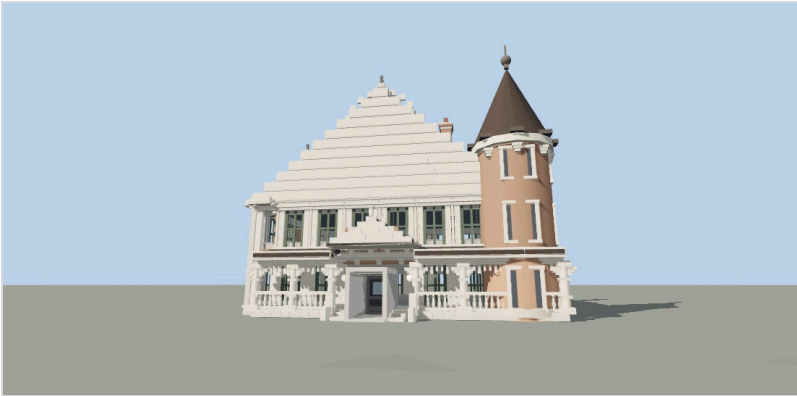
HOUSES · queenanne · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



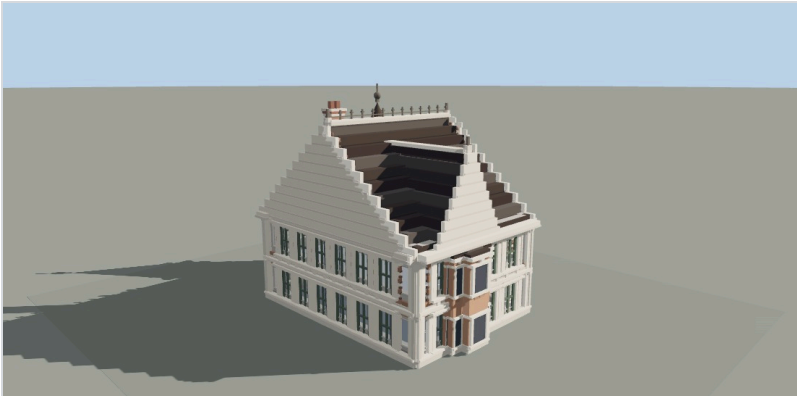
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

The painted lady: asymmetric mass, a corner turret, a wraparound porch, three colours of shingle and spindlework everywhere.

AS A CITY: An 1890s residential hill. Siblings: Stick, Shingle, Eastlake.
The most ornament per square metre in the kit.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+9.1 m	Tallest point	15.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	24	Triangles	31,954
Merged deco boxes (free)	2598	Minted meshes (not)	15

22 Greek Revival Mansion

HOUSES · greekrev · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

A temple bolted to a house: gable turned to the road, full-height colonnade in front of it, a real pediment with a shadowed tympanum, painted dead white.

AS A CITY: A courthouse-square town of white temple fronts — bank, academy, two churches, the big house on the hill.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+6.1 m	Tallest point	12.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	15	Triangles	14,496
Merged deco boxes (free)	1176	Minted meshes (not)	6

23 Antebellum Plantation House

HOUSES · plantation · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Antebellum: a two-storey gallery running the full width on both floors, columns from ground to roof, hipped roof with dormers.

AS A CITY: A river road of galleried houses, an overseer's cottage, a raised creole townhouse.



From the pavement — the entrance

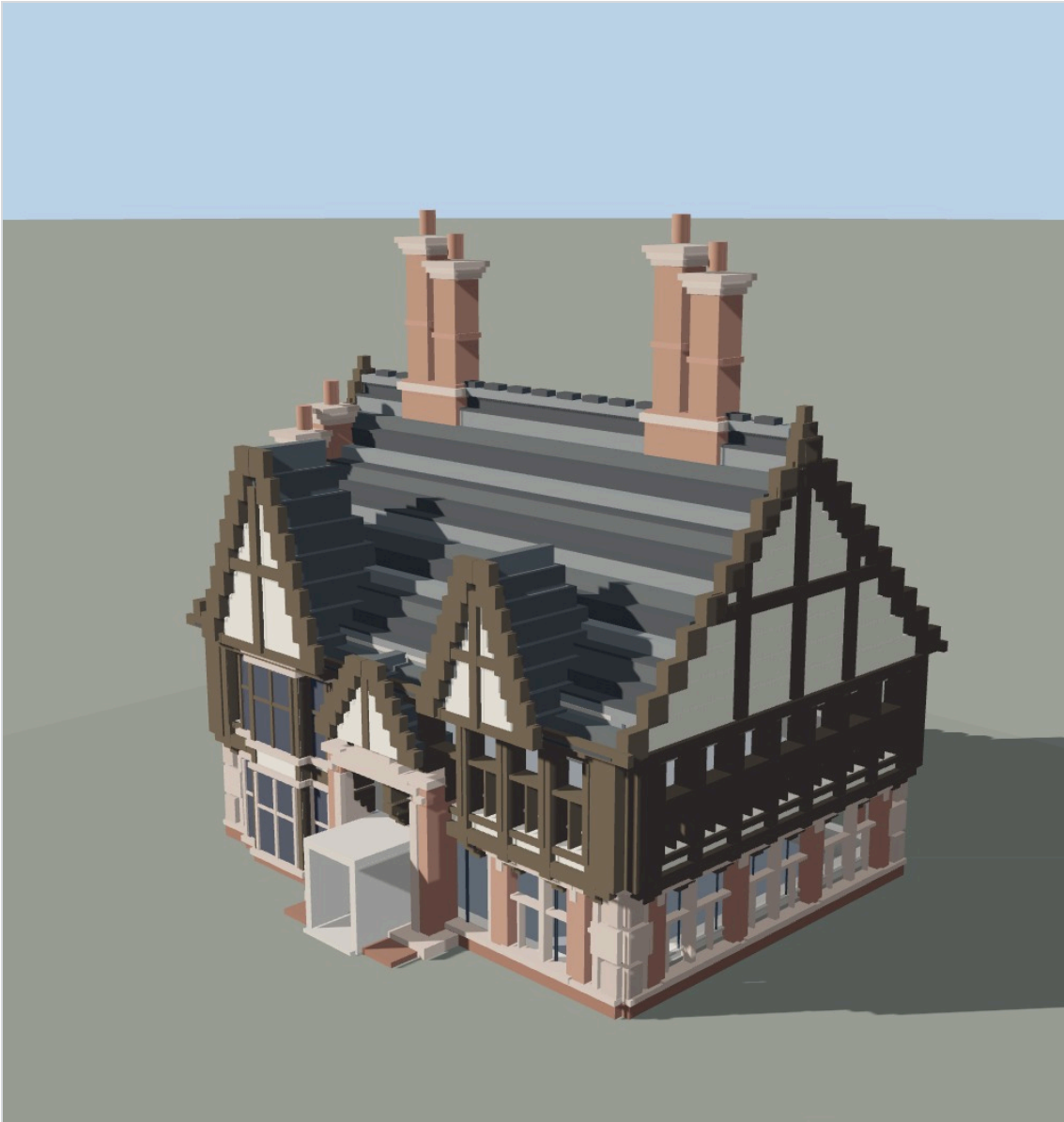


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+5.1 m	Tallest point	11.5 m
Things breaking the roofline	18	Triangles	32,488
Merged deco boxes (free)	2694	Minted meshes (not)	2

24 English Manor

HOUSES · manor · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



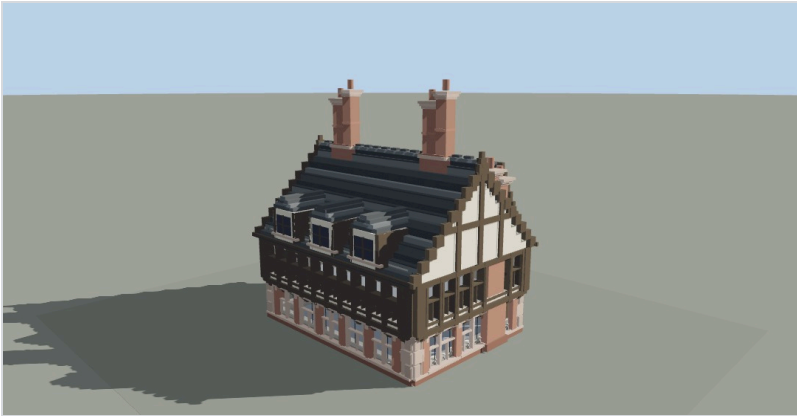
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

English manor: steep gables, half-timbering, tall grouped chimney stacks, leaded casements, a stone porch bay.

AS A CITY: A Tudor village — inn, church, market hall, timbered terrace.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+11.4 m	Tallest point	17.8 m
Things breaking the roofline	20	Triangles	13,224
Merged deco boxes (free)	1086	Minted meshes (not)	6

25 Brick Colonial House

HOUSES · brickhouse · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Georgian/Colonial: solid brick laid symmetrically about a centre door, side-gabled roof, a chimney at each end. Its argument is DECORUM.

AS A CITY: A colonial town of manners — meeting house, tavern, the row houses, the governor's house.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+6.6 m	Tallest point	13 m
Things breaking the roofline	16	Triangles	17,056
Merged deco boxes (free)	1408	Minted meshes (not)	2

26 Spanish Colonial Mansion

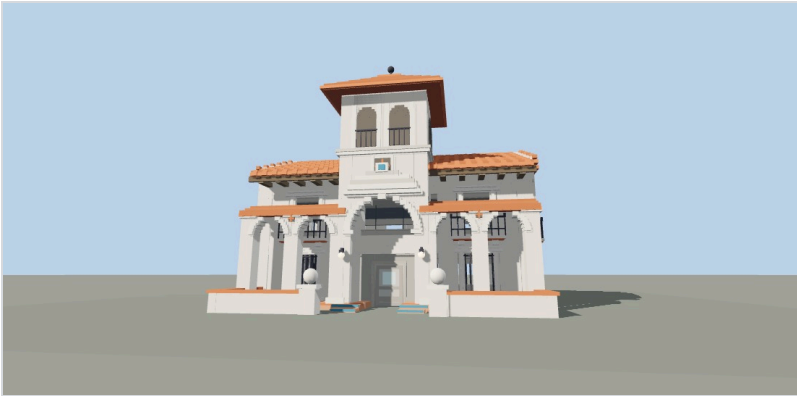
HOUSES · spanish · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Spanish Colonial: white stucco, a low-pitch clay barrel-tile roof, arcaded loggia, wrought iron, a bell-gable.

AS A CITY: A mission town: the mission itself, the hacienda, the plaza arcade, the courtyard house.



From the pavement — the entrance

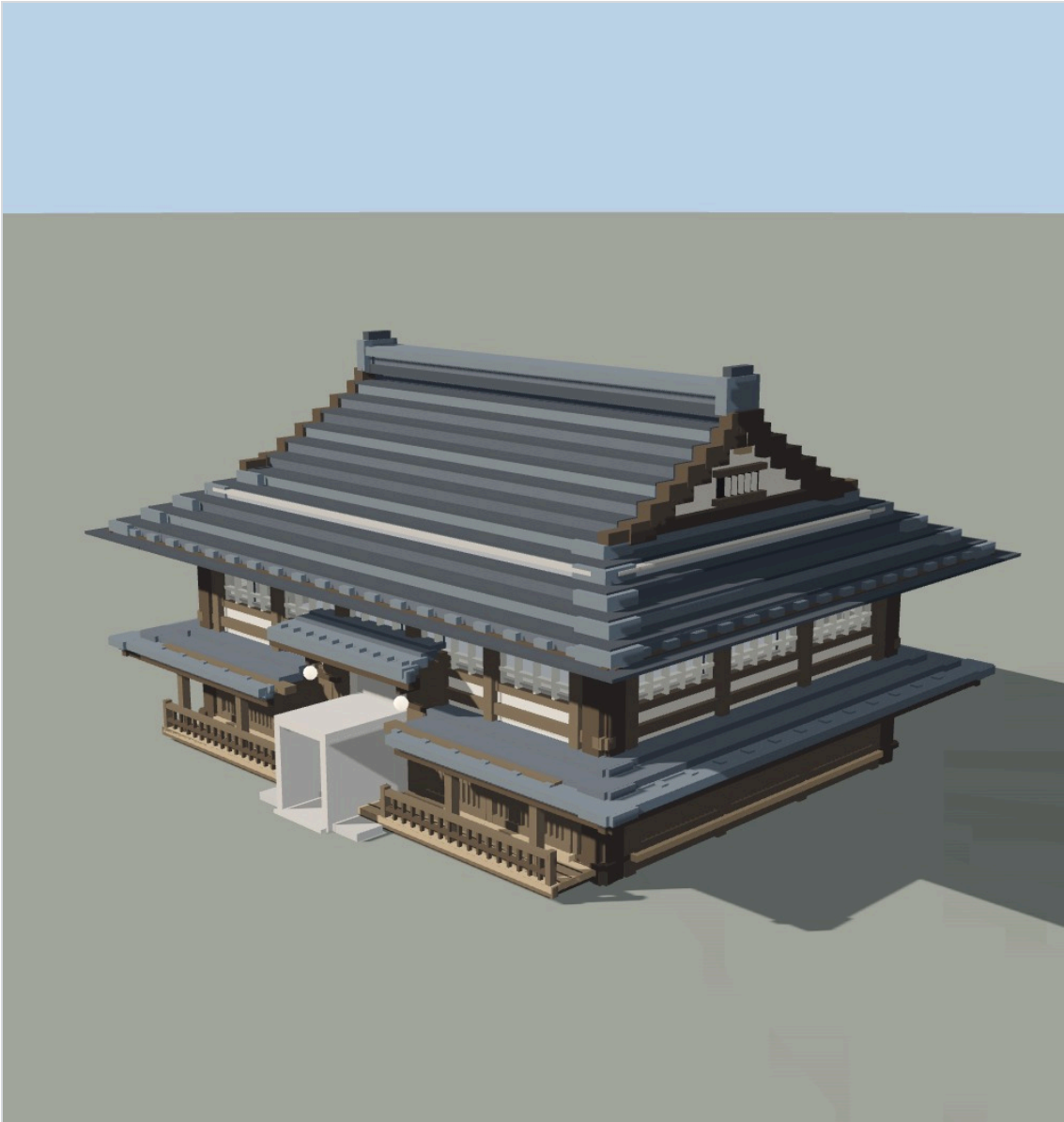


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+7.6 m	Tallest point	14 m
Things breaking the roofline	21	Triangles	20,932
Merged deco boxes (free)	1701	Minted meshes (not)	5

27 Japanese Residence

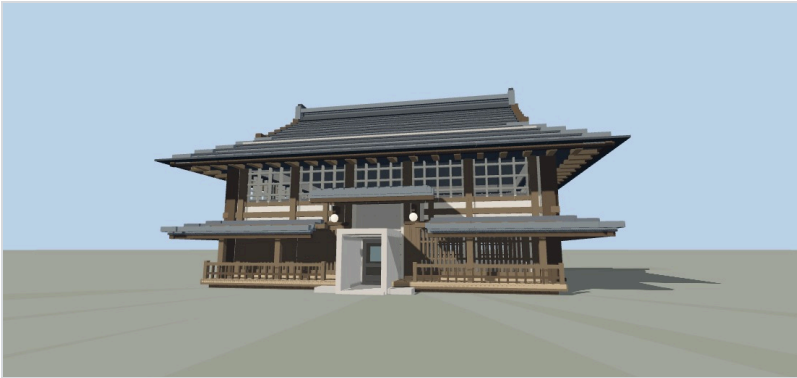
HOUSES · machiya · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



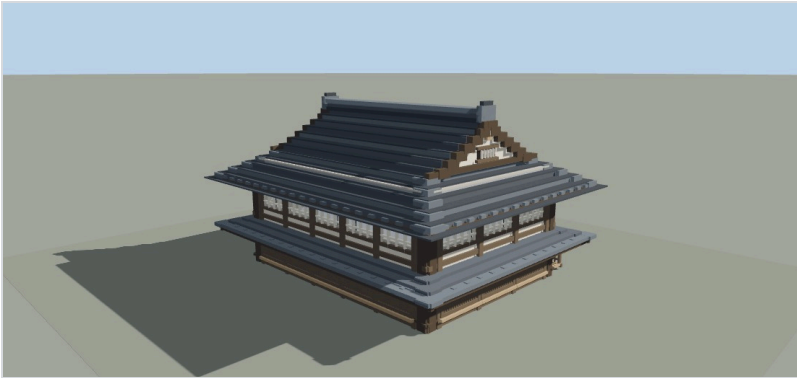
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Japanese townhouse/minka: a low timber frame with pale plaster infill, a veranda deck along the street face, one enormous tiled roof with deep eaves.

AS A CITY: A machiya street — shop-house, teahouse, gate house, storehouse (kura).



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+4.6 m	Tallest point	11 m
Things breaking the roofline	14	Triangles	16,600
Merged deco boxes (free)	1370	Minted meshes (not)	2

28 Roman Villa

HOUSES · romanvilla · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



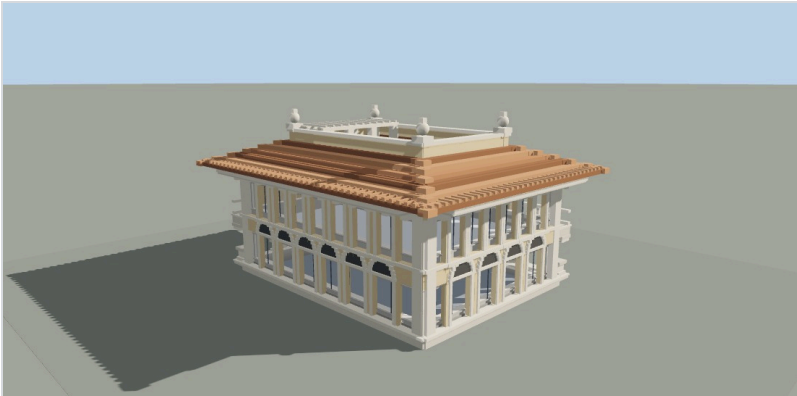
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Roman villa: a low tile roof, a colonnaded peristyle, stuccoed masonry, a courtyard the building wraps.

AS A CITY: A Mediterranean antique quarter — villa, baths, forum stoa, insula.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+3.9 m	Tallest point	10.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	14	Triangles	18,420
Merged deco boxes (free)	1495	Minted meshes (not)	4

29 Desert Modern House

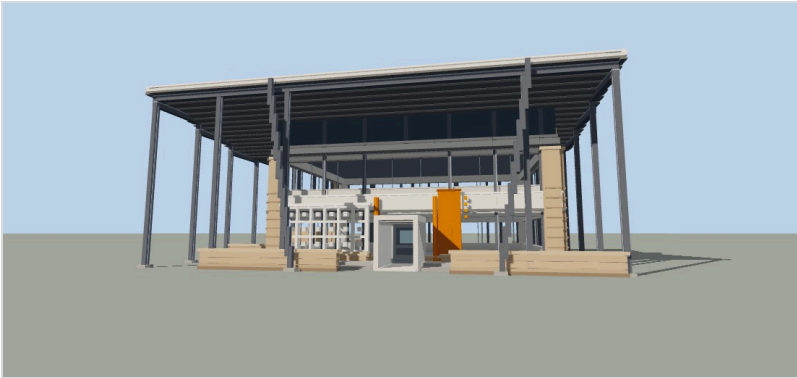
HOUSES · desertmod · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Palm Springs, 1962. A single thin roof blade with 2-6 m of overhang, steel posts, plate glass, a breeze-block screen. Architecture as the management of sun.

AS A CITY: A mid-century desert suburb: butterfly roof, folded plate, the post-and-beam, the screen-wall bungalow.



From the pavement — the entrance

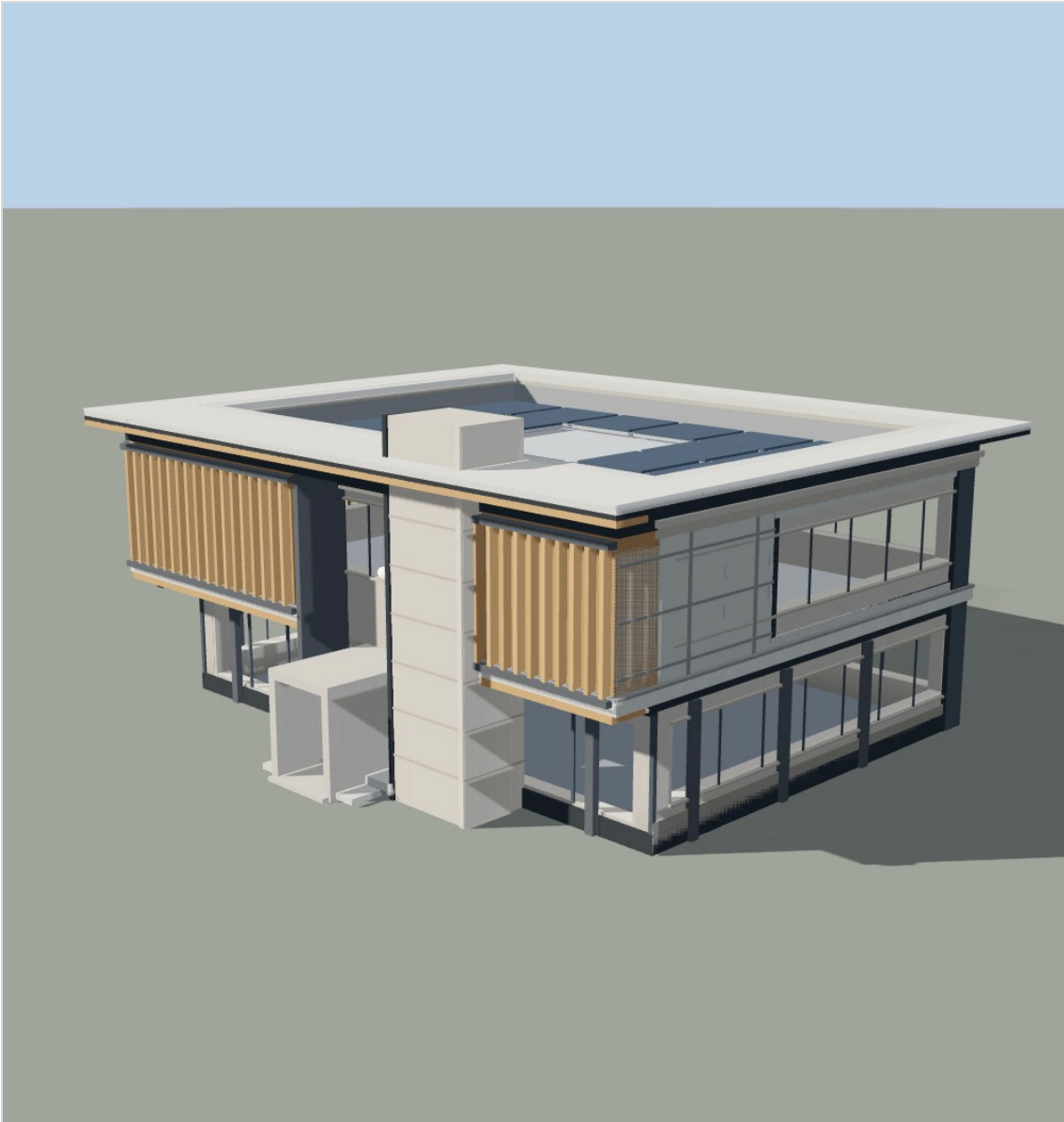


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+3.6 m	Tallest point	10 m
Things breaking the roofline	18	Triangles	11,136
Merged deco boxes (free)	928	Minted meshes (not)	0

30 Modern Tech House

HOUSES · techhouse · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



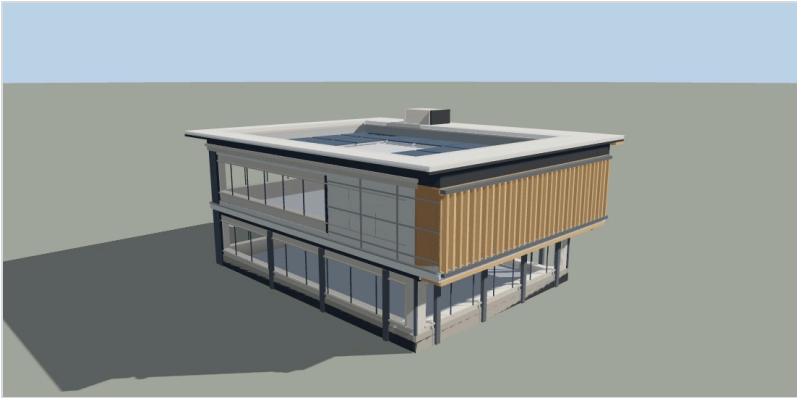
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Contemporary glass house: stacked cantilevered volumes, floor-to-ceiling glazing, a wood-slat screen, a flat roof with a parapet.

AS A CITY: A hillside of modern spec houses. The least characterful pick, and the most likely to read as generic.



From the pavement — the entrance

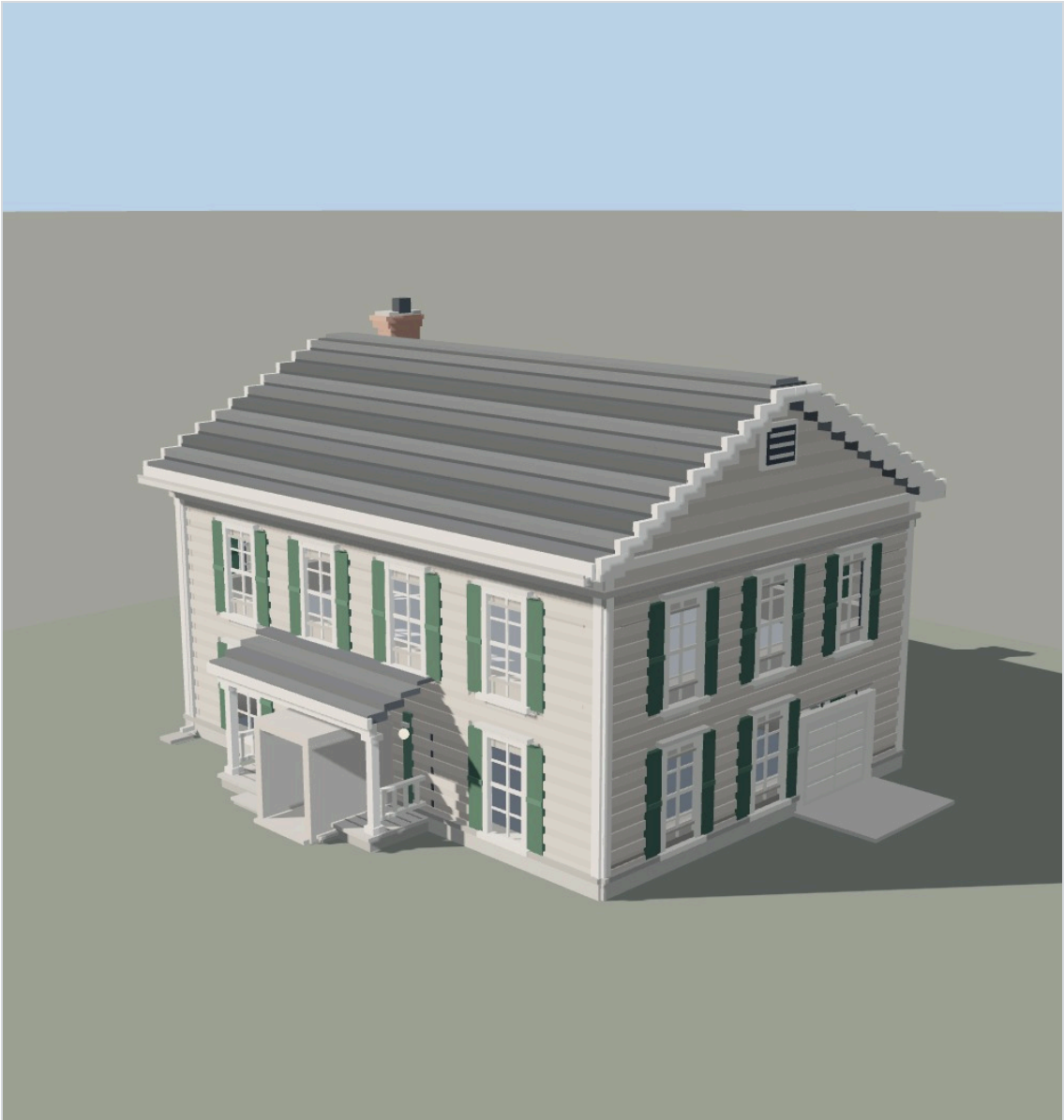


Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+1.6 m	Tallest point	8 m
Things breaking the roofline	9	Triangles	6,012
Merged deco boxes (free)	481	Minted meshes (not)	3

31 Plain House

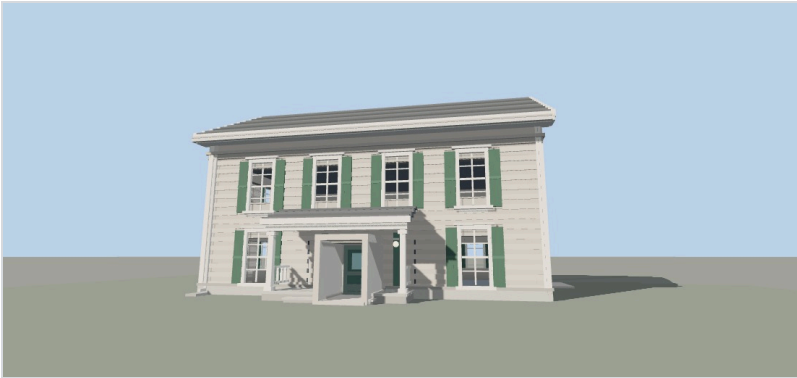
HOUSES · ranch · 15×11 M, 2 STOREYS



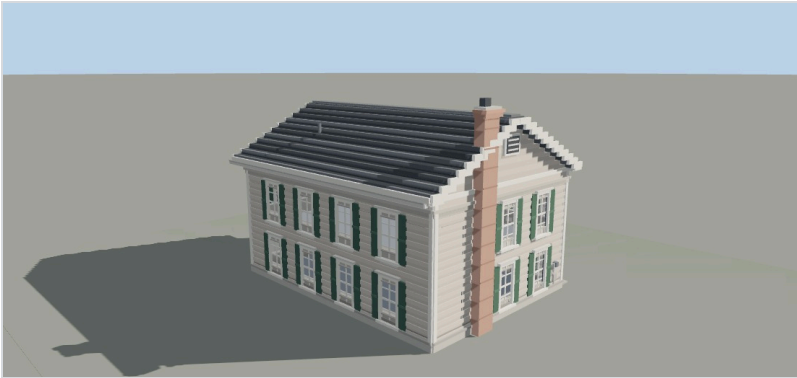
Three-quarter — the honest single frame

Plain house. A long low box, shallow gable, picture window, an attached carport. Deliberately the boring one — it is what a street NEEDS between the loud ones.

AS A CITY: Post-war tract suburbia: ranch, split-level, cape, minimal traditional. Background architecture, and a city is mostly background.



From the pavement — the entrance



Rear three-quarter — is it a stage set?

Crown above the bare shell	+4.9 m	Tallest point	11.3 m
Things breaking the roofline	18	Triangles	15,428
Merged deco boxes (free)	1279	Minted meshes (not)	1